

Nora Furnish: store audit and founder-pack handoff

Generated 2026-10-08 from the cloud session. Repo **joehaller00-dev/myfirstapp**, branch **claude/gallant-volta-duv7ha**, folder **founder/**.

Start with section 1 (Handoff); it says exactly where to pick up.

Contents

1. [Handoff \(start here\)](#) founder/HANDOFF.md
2. [Store fix list](#) founder/store-fixes.md
3. [Storefront audit](#) founder/data/storefront-audit.md
4. [Board verdict](#) founder/board.md
5. [Competitors](#) founder/competitors.md
6. [Consumer panel \(100 buyers\)](#) founder/panel/results.md
7. [Panel re-test: honest offer \(20\)](#) founder/panel-v2/results.md
8. [Panel: target-state store \(20\)](#) founder/panel-v3/results.md
9. [Offer](#) founder/offer.md
10. [Pricing](#) founder/pricing.md
11. [Price history evidence](#) founder/data/price-history.md
12. [CFO unit economics](#) founder/cfo.md
13. [Marketing](#) founder/marketing.md
14. [Brand and visual](#) founder/brand.md
15. [Relaunch plan](#) founder/launch.md
16. [Idea file](#) founder/idea.md
17. [Store snapshot](#) founder/data/store-snapshot.md
18. [Board memo: Offers lens](#) founder/board/offers.md
19. [Board memo: Monopoly lens](#) founder/board/monopoly.md
20. [Board memo: Product lens](#) founder/board/product.md
21. [numbers.json \(CFO inputs\)](#) founder/numbers.json

HANDOFF: Nora Furnish store audit (paste this whole file into the new chat)

Written: 2026-10-08, when the cloud session was stopped at the owner's request (it was running on cloud usage; the owner wants to continue locally). **Repo:** joehaller00-dev/myfirstapp, branch `claude/gallant-volta-duv7ha`. Everything is in `founder/`. Run `git fetch origin claude/gallant-volta-duv7ha && git checkout claude/gallant-volta-duv7ha` locally. **Skills:** the founder pack (github.com/Jakeschincariol/founder-skill) is vendored in `.claude/skills/founder-*`. Your account also lists them as `anthropic-skills:founder-*`.

1. What the owner asked for, and how they want to work

- **Request:** run the founder pack (board → competitors → consumer → pricing → offer → cfo → marketing → brand → ops → launch → plan) on their live Shopify store **Nora Furnish (norafurnish.com)**: high-ticket home decor, mainly lighting, sold online. Goal: "find all the kinks and mishaps... what could be visually better and what could be better back-end wise."
- **Mid-session correction from the owner:** the prompt came from Instagram, so **don't follow it to the letter where it doesn't fit an existing store**. They already have `norafurnish.com`, so no domain or naming work. They want practical help.
- **Preferences:** be direct, don't default to agreement, challenge ideas; give answers, not explanations of every detail; try several things before presenting; work through multi-step tasks without stopping; only stop for a genuine decision; "if I tell you to do something just do it"; no attitude.
- **Not done yet:** nothing in the live store has been changed. Every Shopify call so far was read-only. Live-store changes still need the owner's go-ahead (see §6).

2. The store in numbers (Shopify Admin data, 2026-10-08)

- Shopify **Basic** plan, USD, ships to the US only. Theme `nora-v5-mobile-menu` (custom Prestige fork, id `gid://shopify/OnlineStoreTheme/167135674420`) plus 9 spare themes. Owner address on the policy page: Edmond, Oklahoma. Email-only support today (Shopify Inbox chat block is enabled in the theme).
- **Catalog:** 1,819 active and 248 draft products, 185 collections, ~100 messy product types. Every active product shows 0 inventory with "continue selling" (dropship). Price bands: <\$100: 595 | \$100-300: 854 | \$300-600: 596 | \$600-1k: 398 | \$1k+: 391.
- **Sales:** 14 real orders ever (the rest are \$0 owner tests); 4 refunded; **kept net revenue \$2,600.83** (Aug-Oct 2026). 28 customer records.
- **Traffic:** ~14k sessions since Feb 2026; 9,597 in the last 90 days. Real purchase conversion **~0.15%**. Mobile add-to-cart 1.7%. Google organic is the only channel that converts (1,889 sessions, 7 orders, 0.37%). The Sept 11-15 spike and Facebook/Sweden/Ireland "checkout" sessions look like bots or owner testing (only 4 abandoned checkouts carry contact details).
- **Shipping reality:** carriers YunExpress, SFC, WANB (China cross-border); 14-21 days order to door.

3. Key findings (most serious first)

1. **Fake reviews (legal risk):** all 838 Judge.me reviews are imported (AliExpress), 0 verified, shown as "Verified Buyer". The homepage says "every photo was taken by someone who bought the piece". The

About page shows a hand-set "1,368 reviews". This conflicts with the FTC Consumer Reviews Rule (16 CFR 465) and risks a Google Merchant Center suspension.

2. **Fake "was" prices (legal risk):** in Sep/Oct, prices were raised 2.4-4.5x (bulk update 2026-10-07): night light \$17.99 → \$49.99 (cost \$4.18); Nordic wood ceiling light \$39.99 → \$177.99; Cascading Ring chandelier \$514.99 → \$1,337.99 with a "was \$1,672.99" and a clearance tag on a made-to-order item. Compare-at prices were never charged (FTC 16 CFR 233.1). The sale countdown never ends (Fall → Halloween). Evidence: `founder/data/price-history.md`.
3. **"Best Sellers" are another store's best sellers:** 50 of 74 items are tagged `dazuma-best-seller`. The catalog is lifted from Dazuma (~200 items), Baskoraa (73) and AliExpress (72), down to URLs and SKUs. Google Lens finds the same items for 2-18x less (Walmart \$10 vs Nora \$178 for the Nordic light; Amazon \$68-90 vs \$185 for the moon lamp).
4. **Unbacked claims:** "assembled by hand in small batches... the workshop", "Handcrafted", "U.S.-based retailer" with no ship-from disclosure. Two contradictory warranty answers ("no warranty" vs "30-day warranty"). Every product, including 337 made-to-order items, shows a green "In stock".
5. **Safety and specs:** no UL/ETL listing on any sampled product; E14 bulbs and 90-260V or 220V variants offered; no lumens, watts or CRI even on a \$1,337 fixture.
6. **Anonymous store:** no phone, no name, address hidden in a policy page.
7. **Unfocused:** Halloween inflatables, shoe boxes, curtains and incense next to \$1k chandeliers; 15 top-level menu items; 17 homepage sections with the trust strip last; 8 live discount mechanisms plus a \$250 "membership".
8. **Visual (from theme files):** 5 font families (Roboto Serif Light with wide tracking, Montserrat, plus Fraunces, Lora and Inter loaded in the layout); 30px rounded cards; hover "second image" turned off; furniture swatch colours left over; ~150 `_bak_*` theme files; 430 KB of CSS; Google Ads gtag deferred up to 12 seconds.
9. **Trademark flag:** Nora Lighting Inc. owns NORA LIGHTING in Class 11 (Reg. 2939989 and 5939753). Get a clearance opinion before spending on the brand. The owner keeps the name; this is a legal check, not a rename push.
10. **Good, keep:** 31 strong buying-guide blog posts; the day-to-night kitchen slider; honest "design concepts, not client projects" disclosures; detailed product-page structure; Apple Pay and Google Pay.

4. Founder pack results so far

Step	Status	File	Headline
board	✓	<code>board.md</code> , <code>board/*.md</code>	3 PASS , average 2.7/10 (Offers 3, Monopoly 2, Product 3). Strongest version: about 100-150 sampled, UL-listed statement lights, honest prices, free returns, dated delivery, plus a trade/STR channel
competitors	✓	<code>competitors.md</code> , <code>competitors.csv</code>	No gap for the store as it runs today (Homary sells the same genre cheaper with 7k+ reviews). A gap exists only for an "honest sculptural-lighting store": origin and lead time up front, prepaid returns, UL-listed, Lens-proof pricing
consumer	✓	<code>customer.json</code> , <code>pitch-v1.md</code> , <code>panel/results.md</code>	0/100 buy (trust 88, timing 8, price 4). Flip levers: free returns 94, real photo reviews 91, faster or firm delivery 51, UL and specs 30
offer	✓	<code>offer.md</code> , <code>pitch.md (v2)</code> , <code>panel-v2/</code>	Honest stack re-test: 0/20 . Objections moved to "no reviews", "cheaper on Amazon" and "too slow"

Step	Status	File	Headline
(extra) target-state test	✓	pitch-v3-target.md, panel-v3/ data/pricing-curve-v3.md	With 60 real reviews, US stock (3-5 days), \$249, UL listed: 9/20 (45%, an upper bound) . Price checkers and big-retailer loyalists still say no (generic, Lens-able product)
pricing	✓	pricing.md, pricing-curve.md	Acceptable range ~\$120-\$450. Rule: delist commodity Lens-able items; statement pieces \$250-\$450 at landed cost × 4-6; no compare-at. Hero: Cloud pendant 23.6" \$279 (was \$359.99). Ladder: single / pair-trio 10% / room set / trade 15%
cfo	✓	numbers.json, cfo.md	\$350 order: contribution \$29.25 after a \$120 CAC (\$149 before CAC); break-even 0.42 orders/day ; year 1 +\$941 operating, – \$4,059 after a \$5,000 startup spend; cash needed \$6,030 . Price –10% or costs +15% turns it negative. CAC is the line to watch; conversion must reach ~1% before ads pay
marketing	✓	marketing.md	Positioning: "the lighting shop that shows you everything up front". Channels: Google organic + free listings, Google Shopping on 20-30 hero SKUs (\$30/day), local OKC trade outreach, Pinterest. No Meta ads yet. CAC ceiling \$149, target ≤\$100. Dated calendar Oct 12-Nov 11, 10 hooks
brand	✓	brand.md	No rename. Trademark flag; promise "Statement lighting, no surprises"; visual changes: Fraunces + Inter only, warm paper #FBF8F3 / ink #1F1B16 / bronze links #7A5F3A, 4-8px cards, lit secondary image, 8-section homepage, 6-item nav
ops	🕒 NOT WRITTEN	ops.md (missing)	Research agent stopped before finishing. See §5
launch	✓	launch.md	Relaunch Mon Oct 26, 2026 . Test: 10 hero SKUs on Shopping, \$25/day × 14 days. Success = 350+ clicks, 3+ orders, CAC ≤\$117, mobile ATC ≥3%. Countdown, run sheet, day 7/14/30 reviews
plan	🕒 NOT RUN	summary.md, business-plan.md, one-pager.md (missing)	Run compile.py after ops
store fix list	✓	store-fixes.md	20 fixes in 3 phases (Week 1 legal, Week 2 trust/UX, Weeks 3-6 product/proof), each marked as doable via the Shopify API or by the owner
storefront audit	✓	data/storefront-audit.md	15 ranked issues with evidence and fixes (the source for §3)
catalog economics export	🕒 partial	data/catalog.raw (partial JSON lines)	Agent stopped mid-export; catalog.csv and catalog-summary.md were never written

5. Exactly where to pick up (in order)

1. **Pull the branch** (above) and read founder/store-fixes.md, founder/data/storefront-audit.md and this file.
2. **Visual check (newly possible locally)**: the cloud network blocked norafurnish.com, so nobody has looked at the rendered site. Open the homepage, one product page, cart and checkout on mobile and desktop, then confirm or adjust the visual items in brand.md §3 and store-fixes.md.
3. **Finish ops (founder/ops.md)** with the founder-ops skill. Research still needed: how to verify UL/ETL (UL Product iQ, Intertek directory) and where to source certified decorative lighting; US 3PLs for a 10-20 SKU

stocked line (ShipBob, ShipMonk, Red Stag); a prepaid return label for a ~24×24×16 in, 10-20 lb box; Judge.me pricing and review requests; FTC 16 CFR 465 and 233.1 and the Mail Order Rule; Oklahoma sales tax permit (OkTAP), LLC/EIN, product liability insurance; **US de minimis (\$800) status and tariffs on Chinese lighting (HTS 9405) in 2026**, which may change landed cost; a delivery-date app; Google Voice. Daily routine: orders → supplier PO → tracking → customer updates → returns → reviews. Add a risk register (supplier stock-out, damaged chandelier, Merchant Center suspension, chargeback, trademark letter, tariff change). Update `numbers.json` shipping and tariff lines if real figures differ, then re-run the CFO tool.

4. **Optional:** finish the catalog export (all active products with price, cost, compare-at, tags) to build the keep list of 150-300 lighting SKUs. Query: `products(first:50, after:$cursor, query:"status:active")` with `variants(first:1){price compareAtPrice inventoryItem{unitCost{amount}}}` and tags.
5. **Run founder-plan:** `python3 .claude/skills/founder-plan/compile.py --dir founder --check`, then without `--check`. Write `summary.md` and `one-pager.md`. The verdict will be **Not yet** (the panel buy rate is 0% against the 25% bar, and year 1 after startup is negative). Lead with what has to change.
6. **Ask the owner one question:** "Do you want me to start applying the Week 1 fixes in the live store now?" Recommended first: hide imported reviews and the fake review count, clear never-charged compare-at prices, rename Best Sellers, remove workshop/handmade claims, fix the stale hero and the countdown. **Back up first:** duplicate the live theme, and export current prices and compare-at values to a CSV so every change can be reverted.

6. Tools and access notes

- **Shopify:** the cloud session used the Shopify MCP connector (`mcp__Shopify__*`: `graphql_query`, `search_products`, `run-analytics-query`, `list-orders`) on store `ij7iyx-13.myshopify.com`. The local session needs the same connector authorised. `appInstallations` was access-denied; theme file reads and GraphQL product/order queries worked.
- **Panel tool:** `python3 .claude/skills/founder-consumer/panel.py --dir founder/panel {check,tally}` (seed 18297). Pricing tool: `.claude/skills/founder-pricing/van_westendorp.py`. CFO tool: `.claude/skills/founder-cfo/unit_economics.py` `founder/numbers.json`.
- **Caveats to repeat to the owner once:** the panel is simulated buyers (good for objections, an upper bound on conversion); CFO numbers marked "est." are estimates to replace with real quotes; nothing here is legal, tax or financial advice.

Store fix list: Nora Furnish (norafurnish.com)

Ordered by risk, then revenue impact. "Who" = can be done by Claude through the Shopify Admin API (API) or needs the owner (Owner). Evidence: data/storefront-audit.md, data/price-history.md, panel results.

Week 1: legal and platform risk (do first)

#	Fix	Why	Who
1	Stop presenting imported reviews as "Verified Buyer": remove the homepage proof block (custom_liquid_nfproof), the About/Guides quote walls, the hard-coded 1,368 review count (custom.nf_reviews_count/nf_reviews_rating) and the "Verified Buyer" fallback labels. Either delete the 838 imported Judge.me reviews or show them only with Judge.me's "Collected from another provider" badge under "Reviews of this design from other retailers"; strip their aggregateRating from structured data.	FTC Consumer Reviews and Testimonials Rule (16 CFR 465); Google Merchant Center misrepresentation suspension would stop Google Ads, the only paid channel	API (theme + metafields); Owner (Judge.me admin)
2	Clear every compare-at price that was not the real selling price for 30+ days (165 products show a "reduced" price; 492 in Sale). Remove clearance tag from made-to-order items. Kill the rolling Fall → Halloween countdown; fix the stale "First Days of Fall Sale" hero.	FTC 16 CFR 233.1; Google Shopping sale-price rules; buyers saw \$36.99 items reappear at "\$146.99 → \$123.99"	API
3	Rename "Best Sellers" to "Editor's Picks"; drop "customers love and come back for" and "Best Sellers for a Reason".	50 of 74 items are tagged dazuma-best-seller (another store's best sellers)	API
4	Remove workshop/handmade claims ("assembled by hand in small batches", "leaves the workshop", "Handcrafted", "handmade character", "all come to us"); disclose "Most pieces ship directly from our partner factories overseas".	Unbackable claims; FTC Act s.5	API
5	One warranty statement (1 year on lighting, LEDs and driver) replacing the two contradictory FAQ answers.	Contradiction; integrated-LED fixtures with a 30-day warranty	API (pages) + Owner decision
6	One shipping truth: replace every green "In stock" with a computed delivery window; made-to-order shows production time; fix About's "5 to 7 days"; one damage-claim window (30 days).	FTC Mail Order Rule; 337 made-to-order items say "In stock"	API (theme)
7	Hide or delist hardwired SKUs with no UL/ETL listing and every 220V/E14 variant; stop selling until certification is confirmed by the supplier.	Electrical safety, NEC, product liability; trade buyers cannot install unlisted fixtures	Owner (supplier certs) + API (unpublish)

Week 2: trust and conversion

#	Fix	Who
8	Human contact: Shopify Inbox chat is already enabled in the theme (keep it, set a greeting and staff it during posted hours); add a Google Voice number, founder name and photo on About, legal entity and mailing address in the footer and Contact page, a real Facebook Page URL.	Owner + API

#	Fix	Who
9	Free 30-day returns on lighting with a prepaid label to the Edmond address; update the refund policy.	Owner decision + API
10	Cut navigation from 15 to 6 items (Ceiling, Wall, Lamps, Outdoor, Trade, Sale-only-when-real); remove Halloween inflatables and seasonal novelty from the homepage; at most 8 homepage sections; trust strip directly under the hero.	API (theme, menus)
11	Unpublish off-niche and sub-\$30 non-lighting SKUs (shoe boxes, inflatables, incense, shower curtains); target about 150-300 lighting SKUs live.	API (bulk status) after Owner signs off the keep list
12	Discount clean-up: delete COMEBACK10, Welcome Back 5%, "Kevin 15", Member 20%, MEMBERWELCOME and the per-product popup; keep Bundle (2+ same collection 10%) and one delayed welcome offer. Pull the \$250 membership from navigation.	API
13	PDP assurance row → delivery date, 1-year warranty, free returns, "Questions? Chat with us"; turn on footer payment icons; enable the cart discount field.	API (theme)
14	Turn on Judge.me post-purchase review requests with a photo incentive that does not depend on the rating.	Owner (Judge.me)

Weeks 3-6: product and proof

#	Fix	Who
15	Spec table metafield on every lighting product: certification + file number, voltage, watts, lumens, CRI, CCT, dimmable/dimmer type, base, bulb included, IP, weight, warranty.	API (definitions) + Owner (supplier data)
16	Sample and photograph the 30 hero SKUs; replace supplier photos; rename _51egv-style handles with redirects; strip supplier SKUs (DZ..., AliExpress property IDs) from customer view.	Owner (samples, photos) + API
17	Reprice hero SKUs to sit near identical listings elsewhere (see pricing.md); one price, no anchors.	API after pricing sign-off
18	Rewrite copy on the 10 products that get paid traffic (Stair Light 180-variant matrix → kit size × CCT).	API
19	Theme clean-up: move ~150 _bak_* files out, delete 9 spare themes, purge unused CSS (~430 KB), fire AddToCart via Customer Events instead of the 12-second-deferred gtag.	API (theme files)
20	Exclude owner/internal traffic and filter bots in analytics before reading the funnel again.	Owner (Shopify/GA settings)

Nora Furnish: Storefront Conversion and Trust Audit

Date: 2026-10-08. **Method:** read-only Admin API (live theme files, pages, policies, products, metafields, Judge.me data, ShopifyQL). Nothing was changed. The public site could not be reached from this network, so everything here comes from the theme source and the store data. I could not see the rendered page, and the mobile layout was not checked visually.

Live theme: nora-v5-mobile-menu (custom Prestige fork, gid://shopify/OnlineStoreTheme/167135674420, last edited 2026-10-07). There are also 9 unpublished or demo themes.

0. The numbers behind this audit

Metric	Value	Source
Active products	1,819 (2,070 in total)	productsCount
Net sales, last 365 days	\$2,600.83 across about 12 product orders	ShopifyQL sales
Sessions, last 90 days	9,597	ShopifyQL sessions
Sessions with add to cart	479 (5.0%)	
Sessions that reached checkout	414	
Sessions that completed checkout	14 (0.15%)	
Mobile: sessions / add to cart / completed	3,691 / 62 (1.7%) / 8	
Desktop: sessions / reached checkout / completed	5,807 / 392 / 5	

The desktop row (392 checkouts reached, 5 completed) is almost certainly the owner testing during the September theme work: September alone shows 366 checkouts reached and 4 completed. **Exclude internal traffic before you trust any funnel number.** The cleanest real signal is mobile: 1.7% of sessions add to cart. That is a trust and offer problem, not a button problem.

Actual top sellers over 12 months: Cloud Pendant Light (\$994.50, 1 order), Motion Sensor LED Stair Light (\$818.90, 2 orders), Adjustable Vanity Picture Light (\$284.99, 1 order), Full Moon Wall Lamp (\$166.50, 1 order), Outdoor LED Rope Tube String Lights (\$142.97, 3 orders). Nothing else sold above \$100.

1. What a shopper sees

Header (sections/header-group.json + snippets/nf-topbar.liquid)

- A utility top bar (help links, Membership, Best Sellers, Ideas & Guides and Professionals dropdowns). The code says: *"Phone links are never shown (the store is email only)."*
- **15 top-level mega-menu items**, in this order: Autumn at Home, Sale, Grand Collection, Ceiling Lights, Wall Lights, Table & Floor Lamps, Ambient Lighting, Outdoor Lighting, Decor, Soft Furnishings, Home Fragrance, Shelves & Storage, Poufs & Floor Seating, Ideas & Guides, Professionals.
- A mobile row of collection pills (nf-cpills).

Homepage (templates/index.json, enabled sections in order)

1. **Countdown bar** (nf-fallbar): sale name from a shop metafield, *"Up to 30% off Autumn at Home"*, a days/hours/minutes/seconds clock, and the button *"Shop Autumn at Home"*. Shop metafields: the Fall sale ran 09-22 to **10-07 23:59**, and *"The Halloween Sale"* runs **10-08 to 10-31**. The clock rolls straight from one sale into the next.
2. Mobile collection pills.
3. **Hero**: eyebrow *"The First Days of Fall Sale"* (hard-coded and stale as of today), H1 *"Shorter Days, Warmer Rooms"*, button *"Shop the Sale"*. The button links to **/collections/best-sellers**, not to a sale collection.
4. *"Shop by category / Pieces Made for Every Home / Carry the season's warmth into every room, before it slips away."* There are 7 tabs: Best Sellers, Ceiling Lights, Outdoor Lighting, Decor, Soft Furnishings, Home Fragrance, Poufs & Floor Cushions.
5. **"Seasonal edit / Autumn at Home"**, with tabs for Fall Decor, Halloween Decor, **Halloween Inflatables**, Throws and Pillows, Candles and Fragrance, and sale badges with struck-through compare-at prices.
6. Two large cards: *"Ceiling lights that finish the room"* and *"Wall Lights That Set the Mood"*.
7. *"Rooms That Glow / The Indoor Collection"* mosaic, then *"Evenings Out Front / The Outdoor Collection"* mosaic.
8. Day-to-night slider: *"Watch the kitchen come alive. Drag across the room to switch every light on, then tap a glowing light to shop it."* This is good.
9. *"New Arrivals / New Outdoor Lighting"* (in October), with "NEW" badges.
10. **Social proof section**: *"Customer photos / Loved in real homes / Real rooms, real light. Every photo below was taken by someone who bought the piece."* It has 12 hard-coded five-star cards, each labelled **"Verified Buyer"**. Examples: *"I simply adore these pillowcases!"* (on a cushion cover); *"I was very anxious but it exceeded my expectations."*
11. *"Shop by room / Room by room"*, then a video zone, *"New Catalog 2026"*, and *"From Our Blogs"*.
12. **Trust icons, at the very bottom**: *"Free shipping across the USA / No minimum, tracked to your door"*, *"30 day returns"*, *"Real replies by email / Answered within 1 to 2 business days"*, *"Secure checkout"*.

There is no separate announcement bar. The countdown bar does that job.

Overlays (sections/overlay-group.json)

These can stack on a first visit: - a newsletter popup (10% off); - nf-offer-popup: *"Drop your email and we'll send you a one time 10% code for this piece."*; - a cookie banner; - the countdown bar.

The cart drawer has allow_discount_application: false.

Footer (sections/footer-group.json)

- Newsletter: *"Sign up to our newsletter and receive 10% off your first order."*
- Contact block: *"Store Name: Nora Furnish / Store Email: info@norafurnish.com / Customer Service Hours: Monday to Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM (CST)."*
- No address and no phone. **Payment icons are off** (show_payment_icons: false).

Product page (templates/product.default-product-v2.json, used by all 5 sampled products)

- Order of blocks: title, price, variants, then a green **"In stock"** line (nf-pdp-stock).

- Assurance row: "Free & tracked shipping / On every US order", "Secure checkout / Encrypted on Shopify", "Easy returns / 30 days from delivery".
- Add to cart with the dynamic checkout button, then Bundle & Save tiers (2 items 10%, 3 items 15%) and a wishlist button.
- Accordions: Key Features, Dimensions, Materials & Care, What's Included, Shipping & Returns, FAQ, Share.
- Below that: "Why you'll love it", a custom reviews section (nf-reviews), a hidden Judge.me widget, "You may also like", spaces, standard, shop-by, catalog and article sections.
- The Shipping & Returns accordion reads: "Email us within 7 days of delivery with a photo..."
- The base templates/product.json has no reviews section and show_payment_button: false, but no sampled product uses it.

Theme settings (config/settings_data.json, key items)

- show_product_rating: true; cart_free_shipping_threshold: 0.
- App embeds: **Microsoft Clarity** and **Judge.me core**.
- Membership: selling plan 6223593524, join code MEMBERWELCOME.
- Social links: Facebook profile.php?id=61578464993386, Instagram @norafurnishllc, TikTok @norafurnish.

Third-party scripts in layout/theme.liquid (87 KB, 35 <script> tags)

- pixel.wetracked.io/{shop}/events.js, loaded async.
- Google Ads gtag with **two** conversion IDs, AW-18133462360 and AW-18130838733. The library is deferred until the first interaction, idle time, or 12 seconds.
- The Meta Pixel was removed ("no Meta or Facebook ads, Google Ads only"); fbq is kept as a no-op.
- A Pinterest domain-verify meta tag.
- Google Fonts: Fraunces, Lora and Inter.
- First-party bundles: custom-nav.js (168 KB), custom-nav.css (210 KB), theme.js (221 KB), theme.css (216 KB), plus about 20 nf-* scripts.
- Clarity and Judge.me are injected through app embeds.
- The theme assets/ folder holds **about 150 _bak_* backup files** (index.json copies, old theme.liquid and so on).

2. Pages, policies and claims

Page	Copy that matters	Problem?
About Us (template page.about-us)	"Nora Furnish is an online lighting and home decor store." / "Orders take 1 to 2 business days to prepare and 5 to 7 in transit, so most arrive within 10 to 12 business days." / Review strip "What people say about the pieces we carry ... quoted exactly as they were written", with a summary of "out of 5 from 1,368 reviews"	The transit time contradicts the policy (9 to 10 days), and 2 + 7 is not 12. The review count comes from a hand-set metafield (custom.nf_reviews_count = 1368) that overrides Judge.me's real total of 838 .

Page	Copy that matters	Problem?
Our Story (body and hub template)	<i>"Nora Furnish started with a simple belief. A home should feel like the people who live in it." / "Design concepts are spaces imagined and lit by our team... They are not client projects."</i>	Honest. No founder, no years in business, no workshop claim. It is also anonymous, which is a missed trust lever.
FAQ (body)	<i>"Nora Furnish is a U.S.-based online retailer" / "We do not offer a separate manufacturer warranty."</i>	Contradicts the FAQ v2 template.
FAQ (template faq-v2)	<i>"Do your products come with a warranty? Yes. Every item ... comes with a 30 day warranty." / "Many of our lights come in two voltage options ... choose the 100V to 120V option whenever a listing asks." / "We accept the payment methods shown below."</i>	Contradicts the FAQ body on warranty. The voltage answer admits 220V stock sold to US shoppers. Footer payment icons are off.
Professionals	<i>"Designers, contractors, hotels, restaurants, offices, shops and homeowners with big plans all come to us..." / "These are design concepts created by our team, not client projects." / "Nothing is made until you approve"</i>	Mostly honest, with good disclosures. "All come to us" implies a client base that the sales data (about 12 orders) does not support. No UL/ETL information anywhere, which contractors need.
Contact	Email and hours only. Form via <code>nf-hc-form</code> .	No phone, no address, no chat.
Contact policy (/policies/contact-information)	<i>"Store Address: 8300 NW 206th St., Edmond, Oklahoma, USA"</i>	The only place the address appears. It is not on the Contact page, footer or About page.
Shipping policy	In stock: <i>"roughly 10 to 12 business days."</i> Made to order: <i>"Production: 3 to 4 weeks ... Transit: 9 to 10 business days after it leaves the workshop. Total: up to 30 business days (about 6 weeks)." / "these pieces are assembled by hand in small batches, finished, wired, tested and crated" / "items that ship from different locations" / freight is "curbside"</i>	This is a workshop and handmade claim made as if it were Nora's own. Nora has no workshop; the supplier does. It never says where orders ship from (overseas), although a 9 to 10 business day transit and dual-voltage stock make that obvious to a careful buyer.
Refund policy	30 days from delivery; change-of-mind return shipping is the customer's; <i>"Drop off your parcel at the nearest shipping carrier location"</i>	No return address and no return-cost estimate. For a \$1,300 crated chandelier going back to an overseas workshop, this is a hidden cost the buyer will ask about.
Membership (/pages/membership, product "Nora Members, 6 Month Membership" \$250)	<i>"Skip the \$2,000+ designer fee", "3D renders of your room", "A design studio in your inbox", "Exclusive pieces and bundles"</i>	A \$250 paid design membership on a store with about 12 orders and no customer reviews. It reads as overreach and reinforces "too good to be true".

Mixed shipping promises a shopper can find: - 10 to 12 business days (FAQ, policy, `nf-pdp-trust`); - 5 to 7 days in transit (About); - *"Most orders arrive in about two weeks"* (Blue and White Ceramic Pendant description); - a code comment in `nf-pdp-assure` says *"6 to 9 business days"*; - up to 6 weeks for made to order; - damage claims within 7 days (PDP accordion) versus 30 days (FAQ and policy).

3. Five product pages

	Motion Sensor LED Stair Light	Cloud Pendant Light	Cascading Ring Staircase Chandelier	Bauhaus Glass Flower Wall Lamp	Blue and White Glazed Ceramic Pendant
Price	\$175.99 to \$1,231.99 (180 variants)	\$146.99+ (35 variants)	\$1,337.99 to \$4,447.99 (7)	\$563.99 (3)	\$311.99 (2)
Compare-at	none	~19% above every variant	\$1,672.99 to \$5,560.99 (a flat 25% above)	none	none (was \$333.99 until 9/27)
Price history (metafields)	n/a	n/a	\$514.99 (pre 9/20) → \$607.99 (9/21) → \$1,215.99 → \$1,337.99 (9/27) , compare-at added, tagged clearance while also made-to-order	\$511.99 → \$563.99 ("MTO +15% then lighting +10%")	\$201.99 → ×1.4 "fragile" \$282.99 (compare-at \$333.99) → \$311.99
Source tags	needs-info, pmax-launch	best-seller + dazuma-best-seller, clearance + made-to-order, Dazuma SKUs DZ51EGV0B	clearance, made-to-order	baskoraa-2026-09	aliexpress-2026-09, SKU embeds AliExpress item ID
Images / alt	15 images. Alt texts are oa_hero_8866942156852 and then blanks.	19 images, good descriptive alts	21 images, good alts	8 images, every alt is the title repeated	8 images, every alt is the title repeated
Copy quality	Generic and self-undermining: <i>"the finish looks more expensive than it is"</i> , <i>"sips power"</i> . Q&A: <i>"We do not have the exact time out length in our specs."</i>	Filler that makes no sense for an indoor pendant: <i>"It is wired in rather than solar, so the output holds up through winter and on overcast days."</i> Typo "2700K 3999K". The SEO description repeats its first sentence twice.	Strong: drop lengths, install guidance, care, FAQ, a 1,000-word article	Decent: dimensions, <i>"1 E14 LED bulb"</i> , <i>"AC 90V to 260V"</i> , <i>"Handcrafted glass"</i>	Thin: a 226-character description, <i>"handmade character"</i> in the SEO text
Lumens / watts / CRI / CCT	partial (CCT only)	CCT (typo); no lumens, watts or CRI	none on a \$1,337 fixture	none (bulb not stated as included; E14 base is uncommon in the US)	none
UL / ETL listing	none	none	none	none (a universal 90 to 260V driver suggests a non-US listing)	none

	Motion Sensor LED Stair Light	Cloud Pendant Light	Cascading Ring Staircase Chandelier	Bauhaus Glass Flower Wall Lamp	Blue and White Glazed Ceramic Pendant
Warranty shown	30-day returns only	same	same	same	same
Reviews	1 imported, 5.0, reviewer "Da", verified_buyer: false, dated *2026-02-04	0	1 imported, 5.0, reviewer name "Verified Buyer" , dated 2026-06-30, two months before the product was created (2026-09-04)	0	0
In Best Sellers collection?	No (it is the #2 real seller)	Yes	No	No	No

Verdict on the sample: - Only the Cascading Ring page reads like a \$1,000+ product. Even it has no output, CRI or certification data. - The compare-at prices are anchors that were built after the fact, not prices the items ever sold at. Three of the five products had their base price raised 26% to 160% within the last three weeks.

4. Review app and trust evidence

- **Judge.me** is installed (app embed plus a PDP app block). The theme draws its own reviews UI (sections/nf-reviews.liquid) from judgeme.review_widget_data.
- Judge.me shop totals: **838 reviews, 4.69 average, verified_reviews_count: 0**, trust_badge.is_certified: false.
- Every review checked carries "transparency_badges":["review_collected_from_another_provider"] and "verified_buyer": false. Many have reviewer_name: **"Verified Buyer"**.
- Theme comments confirm the source: *"Photos are re-hosted on our own CDN as Files named nf-review-zone-NN (AliExpress URLs render blank on the storefront)"* and *"source import (REVIEWS_REBUILD_v3.csv)"*.
- The custom nf-reviews section **does not render the transparency badge**. Judge.me's own widget (which shows it) is "hidden until it is needed".
- nf-about-reviews.liquid and nf-guides-page-reviews.liquid print a **"Verified Buyer" badge whenever the name field is blank**.
- The homepage proof block hard-codes "Verified Buyer" on 12 cards. One of them is the Rattan Hot Air Balloon Wall Hanging, **which has no reviews at all in Judge.me**.
- Store replies imply a purchase from Nora: *"Thank you for trusting us with your ceiling light purchase."*
- Products with ratings: of the first 500 active products, roughly 380 (about 75%) carry reviews.rating_count, mostly 1 to 6 reviews each. One product has 19 reviews but 1 order and \$0 net sales.
- The store has had about 12 product orders ever. **None of the 838 reviews can be from Nora customers.**
- Judge.me also writes review_widget_json_ld with aggregateRating into product structured data. That pushes imported ratings into Google results.

5. Payments and markets

- `paymentSettings.supportedDigitalWallets`: **APPLE_PAY, GOOGLE_PAY**. Shop Pay status is not exposed by this field.
- Currency USD. Ships to the US only. Plan: Basic.
- The dynamic checkout button is enabled on the PDP template in use.
- Footer payment icons are off, while the FAQ says *"payment methods shown below"*.

6. Blog: 31 articles (blog `blog`, every author "Nora Furnish Editorial Team")

#	Published	Title
1	2026-09-27	Nora Members Guide: How the Membership Works and When It Pays for Itself
2	2026-09-19	How to Clean a Crystal Chandelier Safely
3	2026-09-16	How to Light a Front Porch So It Feels Welcoming and Safe
4	2026-09-13	Staircase Lighting Ideas for Safety and Style
5	2026-09-09	Bedroom Lighting Ideas for Calm, Comfortable Evenings
6	2026-09-06	Why Do LED Lights Flicker? Common Causes and Fixes
7	2026-09-03	Warm White vs Cool White: Color Temperature Explained
8	2026-08-31	Bathroom Vanity Lighting: Placement, Brightness and Color
9	2026-08-28	Motion Sensor Outdoor Lights: Placement, Settings and Fixes
10	2026-08-23	How to Choose the Right Chandelier Size for Any Room
11	2026-08-22	Lumens, Watts and Brightness Explained
12	2026-08-16	Plug In Wall Sconces: An Easy Way to Add Light Without Wiring
13	2026-08-15	Table Lamp Size Guide for Nightstands and Side Tables
14	2026-08-10	Are LED Lights Dimmable? Dimmers, Compatibility and Buzzing
15	2026-08-07	Flush Mount vs Semi Flush Mount Ceiling Lights: Which Fits Your Room
16	2026-08-04	How to Choose a Floor Lamp for Reading
17	2026-08-02	Wall Sconce Height and Spacing Guide for Every Room
18	2026-07-29	Kitchen Island Pendant Lights: Size, Spacing and Height
19	2026-07-25	How to Layer Lighting in a Living Room
20	2026-07-21	How to Replace a Ceiling Light Fixture
21	2026-07-20	How to Light Artwork at Home With Picture Lights
22	2026-07-14	LED Strip Lights: Where to Use Them and How to Install Them
23	2026-07-11	Home Office Lighting That Is Easy on Your Eyes
24	2026-07-09	How High to Hang a Chandelier Over a Dining Table
25	2026-07-05	How to Choose a Ceiling Fan With a Light
26	2026-07-02	Night Lights for Hallways, Bathrooms and Kids' Rooms
27	2026-06-29	How to Clean and Care for Outdoor Light Fixtures

#	Published	Title
28	2026-06-26	How to Hang Patio String Lights Without Damaging Your Walls
29	2026-06-22	Solar Outdoor Lights: What to Expect and How to Choose
30	2026-06-19	How Far Apart Should Path Lights Be? A Spacing Guide
31	2026-06-17	What Does IP65 Mean? Outdoor Light Ratings Explained

The topics are solid and buyer-intent focused. The weakness is the faceless byline. A named author with lighting credentials would lift both trust and SEO (E-E-A-T, Google's experience, expertise, authoritativeness and trust signals).

7. Top 15 issues, ranked by revenue impact

1. Imported AliExpress reviews are presented as Nora customers' "Verified Buyer" reviews

Evidence: - Homepage: *"Every photo below was taken by someone who bought the piece"*, with 12 hard-coded "Verified Buyer" cards. - Judge.me: 838 reviews, **0 verified**, every review flagged `review_collected_from_another_provider`. Reviewer names are literally "Verified Buyer". - The custom widget drops Judge.me's transparency badge. - The About page claims **1,368** reviews from a hand-set metafield (Judge.me's real total is 838). - Reviews are dated before their products existed (Cascading Ring review 2026-06-30, product created 2026-09-04). - One featured product has no reviews at all. - Total lifetime product orders: about 12.

Why it costs money: - The FTC Consumer Reviews and Testimonials Rule (16 CFR Part 465, in force since Oct 2024) allows civil penalties per violation for reviews that misrepresent the reviewer's experience with the business. - Google Merchant Center "misrepresentation" suspensions hit stores like this, and Google Ads (the store's only paid channel) stops when Merchant Center is suspended. - Savvy buyers recognise AliExpress phrasing (*"I simply adore these pillowcases!"* on a cushion cover) and leave.

Fix (this week): - Delete the homepage `custom_liquid_nfproof` block, the About and Guides quote walls, and the `custom.nf_reviews_count / nf_reviews_rating` overrides. - Remove every "Verified Buyer" fallback label. - Either delete the imported reviews or render them only with Judge.me's own *"Collected from another provider"* badge, under a heading like *"Reviews of this design from other retailers"*. - Remove `aggregateRating` for imported reviews from the JSON-LD. - Turn on Judge.me post-purchase review requests, with a photo-review incentive, so real reviews start accumulating.

2. Fake reference prices and a sale that never ends

Evidence: - Cascading Ring: base price **\$514.99 → \$1,337.99 in about 3 weeks**. A *"was \$1,672.99"* compare-at was attached, and the made-to-order product is tagged `clearance`. - Blue and White Pendant: \$201.99 → \$311.99 in a week. - 165 active products show a reduced price; 67 are tagged `clearance` (18 of those are made to order, so they cannot be clearance stock). - The "Sale" collection resolves to 492 products. - The Fall sale countdown ended 10-07 and rolls straight into *"The Halloween Sale"* 10-08 to 10-31. - The hero still says *"The First Days of Fall Sale"*, and its *"Shop the Sale"* button goes to Best Sellers.

Why it costs money: This breaks the FTC Guides Against Deceptive Pricing (16 CFR 233.1, a former price must be one actually offered in good faith for a reasonable period). Google Shopping's sale-price rules break the same way. Repeat visitors see the "sale" never ends, and the discount stops meaning anything.

Fix: - Clear every compare-at price that was not the real selling price for 30 or more days. - Remove clearance from made-to-order items. - Kill the rolling countdown; run at most one honestly-dated promotion a quarter. - Update the hero today. - Set prices once at a defensible margin rather than marking up and then "discounting".

3. An anonymous email-only store selling \$300 to \$4,000 fixtures

Evidence: - *"Phone links are never shown (the store is email only)."* Replies take 1 to 2 business days. - The address (8300 NW 206th St., Edmond, OK) appears only in /policies/contact-information. It is not on the Contact page, footer or About page. - No founder name, no face, no legal entity name on the site (Instagram handle @norafurnishllc). - The Facebook link is a bare `profile.php?id=` URL.

Why it costs money: Above roughly \$300, shoppers want to know who they are paying and how to reach a human before checkout. This is likely the biggest driver of the 1.7% mobile add-to-cart rate.

Fix: - Add Shopify Inbox (free live chat) or a Google Voice number for calls and texts, staffed during the posted hours. - Put the legal entity and mailing address in the footer and on the Contact page. - Add a founder note with a name and photo to About ("Who's behind Nora Furnish"). - Use a proper Facebook Page URL.

4. No electrical safety listing and missing light specs on hardwired fixtures

Evidence: - None of the 5 sampled products states UL, ETL or cULus. - Bauhaus lamp: *"Power: hardwired, AC 90V to 260V"* and *"1 E14 LED bulb"*. E14 is a European base; the US standard is E12 or E26. - FAQ: *"Many of our lights come in two voltage options... choose the 100V to 120V option"*. - The \$1,337 Cascading Ring lists **no lumens, watts, CRI or colour temperature**. - Cloud Pendant shows *"2700K 3999K"*.

Why it costs money: The Professionals page pitches *"Designers, contractors, hotels, restaurants..."*. Those buyers cannot install unlisted fixtures under the NEC (US electrical code) or commercial inspection. Homeowners with an electrician will be told the same thing. A 220V variant shipped by mistake becomes a return or a fire risk.

Fix: - Get certification status from each supplier. - Add a standard spec table metafield: certification, input voltage, wattage, lumens, CRI, CCT, dimmable (and dimmer type), bulb base, bulb included yes/no, IP rating, weight, warranty. - Hide or delist hardwired SKUs that have no US listing, and remove 220V variants. - Lead the trade pages with "ETL-listed options available" only where that is true.

5. Warranty: contradictory, and too short for integrated-LED lighting

Evidence: - FAQ body: *"We do not offer a separate manufacturer warranty."* - FAQ v2: *"Yes. Every item ... comes with a 30 day warranty."* - The Cascading Ring's *"LEDs are built in, so there are no bulbs to fit or replace"*. If the LEDs fail on day 31, the \$1,337 fixture is scrap.

Fix: Publish one clear statement: a 1-year (ideally 2-year) replacement warranty on lighting, with driver and LED coverage spelled out. Price it in as roughly 2 to 3% of revenue. Show it in the PDP assurance row, where it should replace the vaguer *"Secure checkout / Encrypted on Shopify"* item.

6. Delivery promises contradict each other, and made-to-order items say "In stock"

Evidence: - About gives 5 to 7 days in transit; the FAQ and policy give 9 to 10. - The Blue and White Pendant says *"about two weeks"*. - Damage claims: 7 days (PDP) versus 30 days (FAQ and policy). - Every product shows a green **"In stock"** line, including 337 **made-to-order** items with 3 to 4 weeks of production.

Why it costs money: The FTC Mail Order Rule requires a reasonable basis for shipping claims. Six weeks of silence after an "In stock" purchase produces chargebacks and the 1-star reviews that will (finally) be real.

Fix: - Build one shipping snippet that every page reads from. - Replace "In stock" with a computed delivery window ("Arrives Oct 22 to 28"; "Made to order: ships in 3 to 4 weeks, arrives about Nov 25"). - Fix the About copy. - Settle on one damage-claim window.

7. "Best Sellers" are a competitor's best sellers

Evidence: - 50 of the 74 products in the Best Sellers collection are tagged `dazuma-best-seller`. - The collection copy says *"Discover our best selling favorites that customers love and come back for."* - The product page ends with *"Best Sellers for a Reason"*. - The store has about 12 product orders in total, and the actual #2 seller (Motion Sensor LED Stair Light) is not in the collection.

Fix: Rename the collection to "Most-Loved Designs" or "Editor's Picks", drop "customers love and come back for", and switch the collection to real order data once you have it. This is a false claim today, and a cheap one to fix.

8. The catalogue is lifted from competitors, down to URLs and SKUs

Evidence: - Tags `dazuma-best-seller` (74), `dazuma-chand-2026-09` (70), `dazuma-outdoor-2026-09` (60), `baskoraa-2026-09` (73), `aliexpress-2026-09` (72). - Handles like `lighting-ceiling-lights-pendant-lighting_51egv` and SKUs like `DZ51EGV0B` and `HA143547-01B`.

Why it costs money: - Anyone who reverse-image-searches a \$563.99 lamp finds the same photo on Dazuma, Baskoraa or AliExpress, often cheaper. That ends the sale. - Copied photography invites DMCA takedowns and Merchant Center duplicate or misrepresentation flags.

Fix: - Shoot or render your own images for the 20 to 30 SKUs you advertise. - Rename the handles (with redirects). - Strip supplier SKUs from anything customer-facing. - Check the price of every advertised SKU against its source, and do not sit far above the identical listing.

9. A lighting brand diluted by Halloween inflatables and plastic shoe boxes

Evidence: - 15 top-level mega-menu items, a top bar and pills. - 17 enabled homepage sections, with the trust strip last. - Homepage tabs include *"Halloween Inflatables"*. - The catalogue includes items like *"12 Pack Stackable Plastic Shoe Storage Boxes"*, incense burners and poufs, sold next to \$1,000+ chandeliers. - 1,819 active SKUs. - The About page says *"Lighting first"*.

Fix: - Cut the main navigation to 6 items: Ceiling, Wall, Lamps, Outdoor, Sale, Trade. Fold decor into one "Home" menu. - Remove seasonal novelty from the lighting homepage. - Unpublish sub-\$30 non-lighting SKUs. - Move the trust strip directly under the hero. - Aim for no more than 8 homepage sections.

10. Best-seller product pages have thin, generic or broken copy

Evidence: - Stair Light: *"the finish looks more expensive than it is"*, *"sips power"*, Q&A *"We do not have the exact time out length in our specs"*, internal tag `needs-info`, 180 variants with AliExpress property-ID SKUs (`136:200002572;...`), and alt text `oa_hero_8866942156852`. - Cloud Pendant: *"wired in rather than solar, so the output holds up through winter"*, an SEO description that repeats its first sentence, and the SEO title *"White Cloud a, White Cloud B, Cloud and more"*. - Two of the five sampled products use the title as the alt text on every image.

Fix: - Rewrite the copy on the 10 products that get paid traffic first: specs, use case, install, what is in the box, and a real answer to every Q&A. - Get the sensor time-out from the supplier. - Collapse the 180-variant matrix into kit size × colour temperature with clean SKUs. - Write descriptive alt text. - Drop the "Nora Furnish" prefix from SEO titles.

11. Too many discounts and popups

Evidence: The newsletter popup (10%), the per-product offer popup ("*one time 10% code for this piece*"), Bundle & Save (10% for 2, 15% for 3), member pricing, a 15 to 30% sale, the countdown bar and the cookie banner can all hit one first visit.

Why it costs money: On a premium price point, constant discounting tells the shopper the list price is fake (see #2), and stacked overlays hurt mobile usability.

Fix: Keep one welcome offer, delay it to exit-intent or 30+ seconds on mobile, and delete `nf-offer-popup`. Keep Bundle & Save only where buying in multiples makes sense (pendants, sconces, path lights).

12. A \$250 design membership before any proof

Evidence: "*Skip the \$2,000+ designer fee*", "*3D renders of your room*", "*A design studio in your inbox*", a Membership link in the top bar on every page, and member reviews switched off (correctly) because none exist.

Why it costs money: It is an unfulfillable-looking promise on a store with no track record, and it distracts from the core sale.

Fix: Pull Membership from the navigation. Offer a free "Send us your room photo, we'll suggest 3 fixtures" email service instead; it builds trust and captures leads. Relaunch the membership after 100 real orders.

13. Payment and trust signals are missing where decisions happen

Evidence: - Footer payment icons are off. - The FAQ references "*payment methods shown below*". - The homepage trust row sits below the blog. - The PDP assurance row offers "*Secure checkout / Encrypted on Shopify*" instead of things buyers weigh (warranty, delivery date, returns cost). - The cart drawer has discount entry disabled while two popups email out codes.

Fix: - Turn the footer payment icons on. - Show Apple Pay, Google Pay, Shop Pay and PayPal (if enabled) under Add to Cart. - Change the PDP row to: delivery date, warranty, 30-day returns, and "Questions? Chat with us". - Enable the discount field in the cart, or apply the welcome code automatically by link.

14. Theme weight and tech debt

Evidence: - `layout/theme.liquid` is 87 KB with 35 script tags. - `custom-nav.css` is 210 KB and `custom-nav.js` 168 KB, on top of `theme.css` (216 KB) and `theme.js` (221 KB). - `index.json` is 132 KB, with Liquid loops over 8 collections (twice) and up to 40 products ×4 for image picking. - About 150 `_bak_*` files sit in theme assets, plus 9 spare themes. - Google Ads gtag is deferred up to 12 seconds, so early add-to-cart events from bounced mobile sessions can be lost to Smart Bidding (Google Ads' automated bidding).

Fix: - Move backups to git. - Split and purge unused CSS (`custom-nav` plus theme together is about 430 KB of CSS). - Replace the homepage image-picking loops with fixed images. - Test Core Web Vitals on mobile. - Fire the AddToCart conversion through Shopify Customer Events instead of the delayed gtag.

15. Craft and origin claims a dropship store cannot back up

Evidence: - Shipping policy: *"assembled by hand in small batches... after it leaves the workshop"*. - Bauhaus lamp: *"Handcrafted glass"*. - Ceramic pendant SEO: *"handmade character"*. - FAQ: *"U.S.-based online retailer"*, with no ship-from disclosure while transit is 9 to 10 business days. - Professionals: *"...all come to us"*.

Fix: - Use *"our manufacturing partners build each made-to-order piece"*. - State plainly *"Most pieces ship directly from our partner factories overseas; transit is 9 to 10 business days"*. Honesty about origin converts better than buyers discovering it from a tracking number. - Drop *"all come to us"*.

8. What is genuinely good

- **Honest concept disclosures.** Professionals, Portfolio and Our Story all say *"These are design concepts created by our team, not client projects."* Most dropship stores fake this; Nora does not.
 - **No invented founder myth.** There is no fake *"family workshop since 1987"*, years in business or invented team. The pages are anonymous, but not fabricated.
 - **PDP information architecture is better than most in the category.** It has per-variant dimension metafields with a drawn dimension chart, *"What's Included"*, care, install guidance (*"Have an electrician do the installation"*), measure-before-ordering prompts, a per-product FAQ, and long-form articles. The Cascading Ring page is close to excellent apart from specs and certification.
 - **Clear, detailed shipping policy.** It covers in-stock versus made-to-order timelines, a 24-hour change window, curbside freight, partial shipments, cutoff times and carriers. Fix the contradictions elsewhere and it becomes a trust asset.
 - **Simple, real offer basics.** Free US shipping with no minimum, 30-day returns, and damage covered at no cost.
 - **The day-to-night kitchen slider and "Room by room" band** are distinctive, shoppable and on-brand for lighting.
 - **The blog.** 31 practical, buyer-intent guides (sizing, spacing, CCT, lumens, IP ratings) in 4 months, linked from room tiles and product pages. This is the store's best long-term organic asset.
 - **The empty-reviews state is honest.** The custom reviews section shows *"No reviews yet. Be the first..."* rather than fake stars when a product has none.
 - **Performance awareness.** The hero image is preloaded, unused font preloads were removed and tag libraries are deferred. Someone is watching speed; it just needs a cleanup pass.
 - **Apple Pay, Google Pay and dynamic checkout** are on.
-

Fix order in one line

Remove the fake reviews and fake anchors (#1 and #2) this week, because they are the legal and Merchant Center risk. Next, add a human contact, address, warranty and delivery dates (#3, #5, #6). Then fix specs and certification and own the photography for the products you advertise (#4, #8). After that, trim the store back to a lighting brand (#9).

Board verdict: Nora Furnish

Vote: 3 PASS (Offers 3, Monopoly 2, Product 3). Average score 2.7 / 10.

This is a verdict on the store as it runs today, not on the founder or on lighting as a category. All three members said what would bring it back to the table, and those conditions are below.

Risks more than one member raised (most dangerous first)

1. **No reason to trust it at these prices (all three).** An unknown brand, no visible proof, \$300-\$1,000+ fixtures from suppliers nobody has named or inspected. Data: about 0.1% of sessions convert, and 4 of 14 real orders were refunded (29%, a tiny sample).
2. **It is a commodity catalog that competes on discounts (all three).** 1,819 SKUs across about 100 product types (chandeliers next to Halloween inflatables and shower curtains), 8 live discount mechanisms and compare-at anchors. If the same items are a Google Lens search away at a fraction of the price, the margin disappears. Open question for /founder-competitors.
3. **The business owns none of the experience after checkout (Offers, Product).** 10-12 business days for "in stock", about 6 weeks for made-to-order, packaging and condition left to the supplier, and buyer-paid returns on bulky, fragile fixtures.
4. **No focus (all three).** Seven trade verticals, six custom service lines, three customer types, zero trade revenue. The homepage drew 3,275 sessions and 0 orders.
5. **Distribution is unproven (Offers, Monopoly).** Google organic is the only channel that converts (0.37%). CAC is unknown because no real paid test has run.

Where the board disagrees

- **Which buyer.** The Offers lens sees the real pain in trade buyers (designers, STR hosts, contractors) on deadlines. The Product lens says start with the experience that already works: a homeowner searching for a specific statement pendant or wall light. The Monopoly lens wants a niche small enough to own: STR room packages, one style, or the Oklahoma City designer trade.
- **What to do with the margin.** Offers: spend it on a guarantee, speed and free returns. Monopoly: it is not a moat, and competitors will compete it away unless the product is exclusive. Product: spend it on quality, or lower prices to match what the product really is.

Conditions checklist (the rest of the pack tests these)

- ☐ Find out whether the top 5 products are sold elsewhere and at what price (/founder-competitors)
- ☐ Pick ONE target buyer and ONE core category (the data points to statement pendants and wall lights) (/founder-consumer, /founder-marketing)
- ☐ Cut the catalog to roughly 50-300 SKUs that serve that buyer, each one the founder would hang at home; remove off-niche lines (/founder-ops)
- ☐ Get a landed cost per order: supplier cost, supplier shipping, processing fees, discounts and returns (/founder-cfo)
- ☐ Price so quality matches price, either by raising quality (sampled, inspected SKUs) or lowering price (/founder-pricing)
- ☐ Replace the discount stack with one clear price plus value the buyer can see (/founder-offer)

- [] An affordable guarantee: ship-by date, free returns on lighting, pre-ship inspection (/founder-offer, /founder-cfo)
- [] Honest delivery promises instead of "in stock" labels on items with zero inventory (/founder-ops)
- [] Visible proof: reviews, installed-fixture photos, named projects (/founder-launch, /founder-marketing)
- [] A differentiator a copycat cannot list overnight: exclusive/private-label designs, custom work, or bundled design help (/founder-offer, /founder-brand)
- [] Measure refund reasons on every order; target under 10% across 30+ real orders in the focus category (/founder-ops, /founder-launch)
- [] A measured CAC from a small, controlled paid test, compared with contribution per order (/founder-cfo, /founder-launch)

The strongest version the board can see

Not the store that exists today. The strongest version is a **focused statement-lighting brand**: about 100 pendants, chandeliers and wall lights, each sampled in hand and photographed honestly, with real specs (dimensions, lumens, UL/ETL, bulb, install) and real delivery dates. It sells at one clear price, with free returns on lighting and a written ship-by promise paid for out of the margin. It sells to two buyers who want the same thing: design-minded homeowners finishing a room, and a small trade/short-term-rental program offering room bundles, sourcing help and trade pricing. That turns the existing trade pages from decoration into a channel. Over time, the best sellers move into a stocked or private-label line so they can't be found under another name on AliExpress. That is a different business from the 1,819-SKU general store, and the board is saying so plainly: polishing the current catalog will not fix the numbers.

Nora Furnish: competitors and the gap

Researched 2026-10-08. Public sources only. Raw rows: founder/competitors.csv.

How this was sourced, and its limits. From this network, direct page fetches were blocked for every retail and review site (norafurnish.com, Amazon, AliExpress, Walmart, Homary, Lumens, Trustpilot, Wikipedia). Reddit was also blocked in search. So every fact below comes from search-engine extracts of the linked page, read on 2026-10-08. Prices are snapshots, and some cached pages are months old. Quotes are reproduced exactly as they appeared in those extracts. Re-check the wording on the live page before reusing any of it. I also could not see Nora's own product photos, so look-alikes were matched on product name and description, not on the image.

The verdict

- **Look-alike test: failed for 4 of 6 products.** A shopper who runs a quick search or Google Lens finds the same kind of item 2x to 17x cheaper on Walmart, Amazon or AliExpress. The worst case is the Nordic wood hallway light: it sells for \$177.99 at Nora, and an apparently matching "Nordic wooden corridor" light is \$10.09-\$11.14 on Walmart. That is about Nora's recorded supplier cost.
- **Nora sits in the worst spot on the map.** It has the delivery speed and trust signals of a Chinese dropship store: 10-12 business days, buyer pays return shipping, and zero public reviews. Its prices sit at the 66th-67th percentile of the market, which is the West Elm and Destination Lighting band. Those stores ship in 1-3 days and have years of reviews behind them.
- **There is no gap Nora can own as it runs today.** There is a narrow, conditional gap, described in section 6. Taking it means changing the model: fewer SKUs, honest disclosure, lower markups and returns the store pays for. It cannot be won by tweaking the current store.

1. The table, sorted by how directly each competes

#	Competitor	Type	Channel	Comparable item and price	Rating (source)
1	Homary	Direct (same model, at scale)	Online US, "Straight from Manufacturers"	Black outdoor lantern \$59.99-\$69.99 ; cloud glass pendant \$379.99	70% 5-star, ~21% 1-star, 7,467 reviews (Trustpilot)
2	Vaxlamp	Direct (look-alike DTC)	Online	Wabi-sabi cloud pendant \$205.44	Mixed, 157-219 reviews (Trustpilot)
3	Articture	Direct (look-alike DTC)	Online	Cloud wabi-sabi pendant from \$499	3.7/5 from 117 (Ratingfacts); 1/5 from 6 (ProductReview)
4	Lyfairs	Direct (look-alike DTC)	Online	Spiral staircase chandeliers about \$1,100-\$1,500	No Trustpilot page found
5	Seus Lighting	Direct (look-alike DTC)	Online	Staircase chandelier \$799.99-\$6,999.99	Not found

#	Competitor	Type	Channel	Comparable item and price	Rating (source)
6	Thehouselights	Direct (look-alike DTC; UK address, reviewers say it ships from China)	Online	Not captured	~3.8, 64% 5-star / 25% 1-star, ~217 reviews
7	Creative.Lighting	Direct (look-alike DTC, Scandinavian branding)	Online	Not captured	2.5, 292 reviews in one snapshot
8	Lumens	Direct (specialist)	Online + trade	Designer brands; free shipping on \$99+ (policy)	"most reviewers were let down" (Trustpilot)
9	YLighting	Direct (specialist)	Online, 325+ brands	Free shipping on \$49+, price match	3.9 from 18, 72% 1-star (Trustpilot)
10	Lightology	Direct (specialist)	Online + 20,000 sq ft Chicago showroom	Bloom pendant \$695-\$1,395	Not read
11	Lamps Plus	Direct (specialist)	Online + ~30 stores	60-day returns (policy)	~4.6, ~15,900 reviews, 85% 5-star (Trustpilot)
12	Destination Lighting	Direct (specialist)	Online	Black lanterns \$96-\$308; Belmore \$218, in stock, ships in 1 business day	Not captured
13	Shades of Light	Direct (specialist)	Online	Outdoor pendants \$144.50-\$337	Not captured
14	Ferguson Home (Build.com plus showrooms)	Direct / substitute	Online + consultations	Not captured	Not captured
15	Rove Concepts	Direct (replica)	Online	Mouille 3 reproduction; lighting is final sale	Not captured
16	Wayfair / AllModern	Indirect	Marketplace	Lanterns \$59-\$299; Kloud glass cloud pendant from \$480	Wayfair USA mostly negative, 783 reviews (Trustpilot)
17	Amazon	Indirect	Marketplace	Moon scone \$68.39-\$89.90; stair kit \$206.99	Per listing
18	Walmart Marketplace	Indirect	Marketplace	Cloud pendants \$34.20-\$264.99; Nordic wooden corridor light \$10.09-\$11.14	Per listing
19	Home Depot	Indirect	Online + stores	Black lanterns \$39.97-\$78.99	Per listing
20	West Elm	Indirect	Online + stores	Weston fluted-glass outdoor scone \$199-\$458	Not captured
21	CB2	Indirect	Online + stores	Pendants \$249-\$1,499	Not captured
22	Rejuvenation	Indirect	Online + stores	Lantern sconces \$349-\$529	Not captured
23	Schoolhouse	Indirect	Online + stores	Pendant \$299-\$449	Not captured

#	Competitor	Type	Channel	Comparable item and price	Rating (source)
24	RH	Indirect	Galleries + online	Outdoor sconce \$229 member / \$395 regular	Not captured
25	Lulu and Georgia	Indirect	Online	Pendants \$225-\$3,490	Not captured
26	Article	Indirect	Online	Gemma pendant \$199	4.4 from 55
27	AliExpress	Substitute	Direct from China	Moon lamps \$33-\$106; stair kits \$64-\$92	Per listing
28	Alibaba	Substitute	Wholesale	Wood round LED lights about EUR 6-54	n/a
29	Temu	Substitute	Direct from China	Listings found, no prices visible	n/a
30	Etsy	Substitute	Marketplace	Cloud lampshade \$41.55 to organic cloud pendant \$473.99	Per listing
31	Local showrooms, e.g. LifeStyles , Edmond	Substitute	In person	Not captured	Not captured
32	Facebook Marketplace	Substitute	Local resale	Not reachable from this network	n/a

The replica and "inspired by" niche barely shows up in the US. The only US replica seller found was Rove Concepts. Its own spec sheet says it is "not manufactured by or affiliated with the original designer(s)" ([source](#)). Designers are suing copiers. Williams-Sonoma has sued Wayfair over a "West Elm-inspired" line ([Bloomberg Law](#)), and a jury found Comptoir des Indes' infringement of Halo's designs "knowing and willful" ([Greenberg Traurig](#)). So the replica route is a legal risk, not a gap.

Nora Furnish's own public footprint: none found. Searches for "norafurnish" and "Nora Furnish" reviews returned no Trustpilot page, no Google reviews, no Reddit threads and no press. Every result was an unrelated business. Reddit itself could not be searched from this network. Against Homary's thousands of reviews and Lamps Plus's ~15,900, zero is itself a conversion problem.

2. Price ranges for the comparable item

Statement pendant, cloud or wabi-sabi sculptural style (single fixture, the Nora Cloud Pendant at about \$292). 18 cloud-shaped listings were found:

- Low: **\$21.00**, Masolighting cloud wabi-sabi ([link](#))
- Median: **\$194.72**
- High: **\$722**, Hugbel Japandi Cloud ([link](#))
- Nora at \$292 sits at about the 67th percentile: 12 of 18 listings are cheaper.

Branded "statement" pendants from the home stores run higher: Article \$199, CB2 \$249-\$1,499, Schoolhouse \$299-\$449, Lulu and Georgia \$225-\$3,490, Lightology designer brands \$695+.

Outdoor wall lantern, black (single fixture, the Nora Reeded Panel Wall Lantern at \$214.99). 32 listings were found:

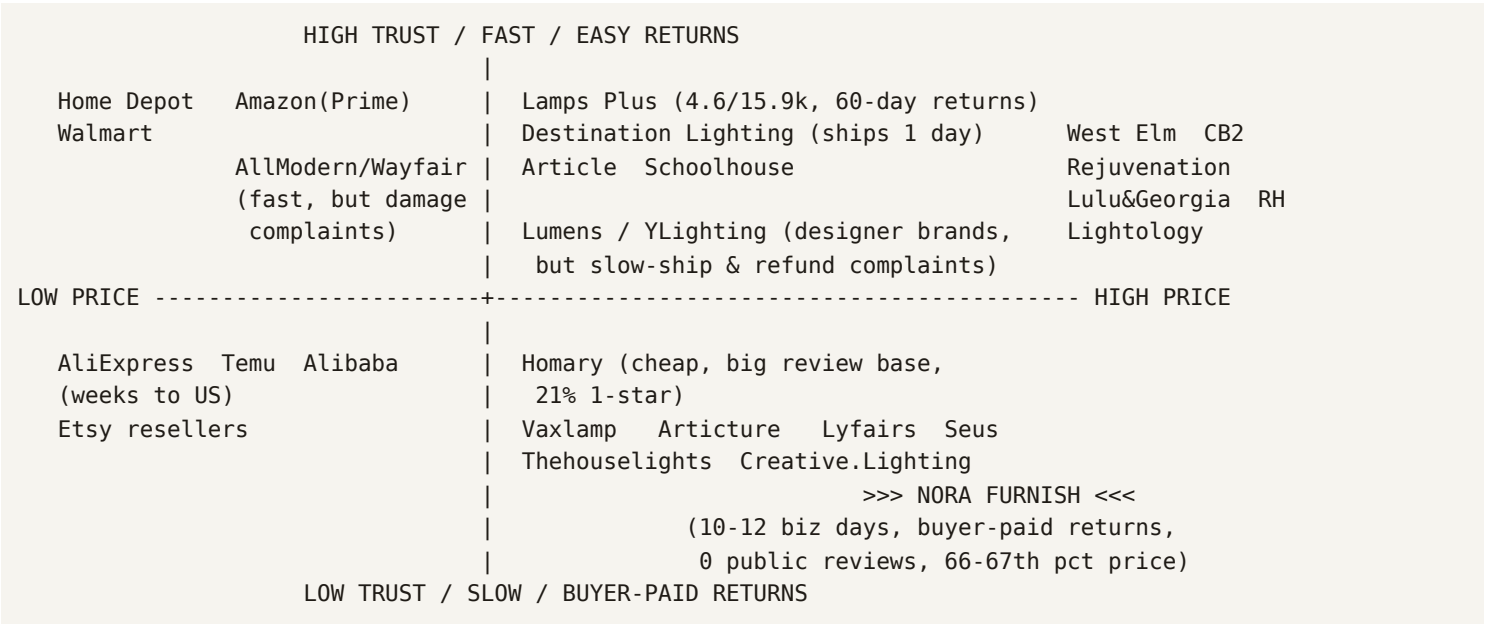
- Low: **\$31.87**, CANARM Ryder, per fixture in a 2-pack ([link](#))
- Median: **\$124.55**
- High: **\$833.80**, Hubbardton Forge fluted, small ([link](#))
- Nora at \$214.99 sits at about the 66th percentile: 21 of 32 are cheaper.

At Nora's price point, the competing lanterns come from US-stocked brands. Capital Belmore is \$218, in stock, and ships in 1 business day. Hinkley Kingston is \$222.88. AllModern Teller is \$229 with free fast delivery.

Fluted or reeded glass specifically: only three listings were found. They are Elegant Lighting Wensley at \$86.50-\$94 ([link](#)), West Elm Weston at \$199-\$458 and Hubbardton Forge at \$833.80+. That sample is thin.

3. Positioning map

The two axes that matter to this buyer are price for the comparable item and **trust and delivery certainty**. Trust here means public review volume and score, US stock and ship speed, and who pays for returns. A \$200-\$900 fixture that has to be hardwired by an electrician is a trust purchase.



Read it plainly. Nora charges home-store prices for a dropship-store experience. Every competitor nearer the top-right gives more certainty for the same money. Every competitor at the bottom-left sells the same genre for much less.

A second axis worth noting is **design distinctiveness**. Nora's top sellers (the cloud pendant, moon lamp, stair kit and wood flush mount) are generic Chinese catalog forms. The same forms appear under dozens of store names: Vaxlamp, Articture, Masolighting, Hugbel, Arturesthme, KTYUERGHK and more. That leaves nothing distinctive to justify a premium.

4. What competitors' customers complain about, ranked

How to read the counts. I could not open the review pages themselves. Each count is the number of distinct individual reviews I saw excerpted for that theme across the top competitors: Lumens, Homary, Wayfair, YLighting, Lamps Plus and the look-alike DTC stores (Thehouselights, Creative.Lighting, Lightsilo, Vaxlamp,

Articture, Moooni and Mooielight). Trustpilot's own AI summaries say several of these themes are "common", so the true counts are higher. A theme with under 3 reviews is marked **thin**.

1. Returns and refunds are hard, buyers pay return shipping, some resort to chargebacks (10+ reviews). Seen at Lumens, Homary, Wayfair, Lamps Plus, YLighting, Thehouselights, Creative.Lighting, Vaxlamp and Articture. - Lumens: "they don't refund you for weeks and weeks and even then you have to dispute the charge on your credit card" ([Trustpilot](#)) - Thehouselights: "I'm expected to cover the return shipping costs of over £70" ([Trustpilot](#))

This theme bears directly on Nora, whose policy is that the buyer pays return shipping.

2. Slow or no delivery, and "in stock" items that don't ship (9+ reviews). Seen at Lumens, YLighting (2), Thehouselights, Vaxlamp, Articture, Lightsilo, Creative.Lighting and Wayfair. - Thehouselights: "They claim they are in Stoke - they're in China. Delivery is supposed to be days - it's months." ([Trustpilot](#)) - Lightsilo: "no further communications, no lights, no response to my emails, but they did charge my credit card" ([Trustpilot](#))

3. The China origin is hidden, the brand or location is misleading, or the product doesn't match the photos (8+ reviews). Seen at Creative.Lighting, Thehouselights (3), Lightsilo (size 25 cm vs 30 cm ordered), Vaxlamp (a "walnut" finish arrived orange), Mooielight and Homary. - Creative.Lighting: "a Chinese company masquerading as a Swedish designer company" ([Trustpilot](#)) - Mooielight: "terrible, cheap quality imitation" ([Trustpilot](#))

This is the theme Nora is most exposed to. The store presents an Edmond, OK address and "boutique" positioning while the goods are supplier-fulfilled.

4. Items arrive damaged or defective, or with missing parts (8+ reviews). Seen at Wayfair (3, including BBB), Homary, Lamps Plus, Thehouselights (one buyer said the total cost with an electrician and replacement parts reached "near £1k"), YLighting, Vaxlamp (faulty driver) and Moooni (tangled wiring). - Wayfair: "Wayfair instead of sending me a return label forwarded my case to the manufacturer" ([Trustpilot](#)) - Wayfair: a replacement light fixture arrived "smashed into a million pieces" (Trustpilot Canada; the extract did not say which of these two pages: [1](#), [2](#))

5. Customer service doesn't answer (5+ reviews). Seen at Lumens, YLighting (5 contacts), Articture, Lightsilo and Wayfair (bot-only support). - YLighting: the card was "charged for all 4 orders, none of which were ready to be shipped out" ([Trustpilot](#)) - Vaxlamp: "so complicated and frustrating that in the end I simply gave up" (on returns, [Trustpilot](#))

6. Overpriced for the quality, or "the same thing is far cheaper on Alibaba" (3-4 reviews). Seen at Creative.Lighting (2-3) and Moooni. - Creative.Lighting: one reviewer said the lamp "wasn't worth 5 euros let alone 85", and another claimed similar lamps cost "less than 1/10 of the price on Alibaba" (paraphrased in the extract) ([Trustpilot](#))

This is exactly what a Google Lens check produces.

7. Unexpected import duties charged on delivery (thin, 2 reviews). - Lightsilo: a courier text asked for tax and duty after delivery ([Trustpilot](#))

8. Coupons don't apply, or promos feel like bait-and-switch (thin at quote level). Lamps Plus's AI summary calls this recurring, but only 1 quote was seen ([Trustpilot](#)).

9. The electrician won't install a fixture that isn't UL-listed, or the fixture can't be mounted as sold (thin, 2 reviews, but material). - A buyer's electrician refused an unlisted wall lamp ([Perigold review](#)). - A Moooni

reviewer said a chandelier needed attic access to mount ([Trustpilot](#)).

NEC 410.6 requires luminaires to be listed ([IAEI](#)).

Buyer sentiment toward dropshipped "boutique" stores in general. Reddit (r/HomelImprovement, r/InteriorDesign, r/Scams) could not be reached from this network, so that evidence is missing. Here is the closest public evidence found: - A fraud-awareness site describes the pattern as AliExpress or Temu goods "wrapped in branded storefronts" and resold at "5 to 10 times wholesale cost". It draws the line at "deceptive representation of commodity products as distinctive branded ones" ([Material Truths](#)). - A 2020 social post called a lighting product a scam because "those lights are on aliexpress for \$25" ([Substack note](#)). - The Trustpilot themes above (hidden China origin, return shipping to China, duties) repeat across five separate look-alike lighting stores.

5. Look-alike price test

The question: does a shopper who checks finds the same item much cheaper?

Nora product (price)	Look-alikes found (price, link)	Gap vs Nora	Verdict
Nordic Wood Round Hallway Ceiling Light (\$177.99-\$201.99; recorded cost ~\$10)	Walmart "Nordic wooden corridor and hallway" LED flush mount, \$10.09-\$11.14 (link); AliExpress wood round hallway lamp ~ \$6.33 , solid-wood round \$34.50 (link); ManoMano 20 cm wood LED £63.92 (link)	16-18x cheaper on Walmart	Fully exposed. Walmart's price is about Nora's supplier cost. This product is also one of Nora's top organic landing pages (181 entries), so Google is sending buyers who can compare in seconds.
Modern LED Aisle Surface Ceiling Light (\$123.99; cost \$8.66)	Amazon listing with a near-identical supplier title, "Modern LED Aisle Ceiling Lights ... Led Surface Mounted for Bedroom Living Room Corridor Light" (price not visible) (link); Walmart aisle LED ceiling lamps \$12.99-\$17.85 ; BLEEUS \$17.19-\$23.39 ; eBay \$17.10 (sources)	5-10x	Exposed. The same supplier title is on Amazon.
Full Moon Wall Lamp (\$184.99)	Amazon 19.5in dimmable moon sconce \$68.39 , Skyblaze 23.6in \$89.90 (link); Walmart from \$77.37 (link); AliExpress \$33.22-\$105.69 (link); eBay 50 cm 24W \$64.15 (link); Temu 23.6in 31W listing, price not visible (link)	2-5.5x (and Amazon delivers faster)	Exposed.
Motion Sensor LED Stair Light (\$861.99; the buyer refunded it, then re-bought at \$819)	AliExpress 1-20 step kit \$64.43 , 1-40 step \$69.43 , MALIIGAZA \$92.21 (link); Amazon MALIIGAZA 16-step \$206.99 (link); Walmart 20-step \$225.99 (link); single PIR step lights \$1.09-\$22 on AliExpress (link)	~4x (Amazon/Walmart) to ~13x (AliExpress), if Nora's item is a step-kit (its exact configuration could not be checked)	Likely exposed. Unconfirmed, because Nora's page could not be viewed.
Cloud Pendant Light (~\$292 each)	Same genre at: Masolighting \$21 (link); Walmart fabric cloud \$34.20 (link); AliExpress silk-cotton cloud \$99.99 (link); Vaxlamp \$205.44 ; Walmart	Ranges from 14x cheaper to 1.7x dearer depending on the version	Partly exposed. The form is a commodity, but Nora is mid-pack, not an outlier. An exact clone could not be

Nora product (price)	Look-alikes found (price, link)	Gap vs Nora	Verdict
	Arturesthme Cloud Wabi Sabi from \$264.99 (link); Articture from \$499 ; Amazon KTYUERG HK polystyrene "Wabi-sabi cloud shape", price not visible (link)		confirmed without the image.
Reeded Panel Wall Lantern (\$214.99)	No exact reeded clone found. Fluted alternatives: Elegant Lighting Wensley \$86.50-\$94 (link); West Elm Weston fluted \$199-\$458 (link). Generic black die-cast lanterns \$31.87-\$69.99 (FETCOI water-ripple die-cast \$50.40 , link ; Homary \$59.99-\$69.99)	1x-3x	Not directly exposed , but priced at West Elm's entry point without West Elm's brand, speed or returns.

Result: 4 of 6 products are clearly or likely undercut by 2x-18x on mainstream US marketplaces (Walmart and Amazon), not just on AliExpress. For the 2 that aren't, it is because no exact copy was found, not because Nora's price wins.

6. The gap

As the store runs today, there is no gap. The evidence:

- On price, the same genre of item sells for 2-18x less on Walmart and Amazon (section 5).
- On trust, Homary already sells manufacturer-direct Chinese lighting with free shipping and 30-day returns, at lower prices (\$59.99 lantern), with 7,000+ Trustpilot reviews. Nora has zero.
- On speed, US-stocked specialists ship in 1-3 days at Nora's price points (Destination Lighting, AllModern).
- On selection, Lamps Plus, Lumens and YLighting carry tens of thousands of designs, with trade programs that already serve the designers and contractors Nora's trade pages target.

A narrow gap exists, but only if Nora changes the model. No store in this map combines all of the following. The look-alike DTC stores fail every one in their reviews, and the specialists don't sell this aesthetic at this price:

"The honest sculptural-lighting store": Chinese-made statement fixtures with the origin and real lead time stated on every page, a short curated range where each SKU is verified as UL/ETL-listed and installer-ready, prepaid returns, and a markup that survives a Google Lens check.

Each piece of that answers one of the top complaints:

Gap element	Complaint it answers (rank, count)	Who already does it
Origin and real lead time stated up front	#3 hidden China origin (8+), #2 slow delivery (9+)	No look-alike DTC store in this sample. Thehouselights and Creative.Lighting are the cautionary examples.
Prepaid or free returns from a US address	#1 returns and refunds (10+)	Lamps Plus (60 days, some free returns), and its 4.6/5 from ~15,900 reviews shows what that buys. No look-alike DTC store does this.
UL/ETL-verified, with spec sheet and mounting requirements	#9 electrician refusals (thin), #4 defects (8+)	Branded specialists, but not for this aesthetic or price

Gap element	Complaint it answers (rank, count)	Who already does it
Price no more than ~2x the visible Amazon/Walmart price, or only SKUs with no cheap twin	#6 "cheaper on Alibaba" (3-4); section 5	Nobody claims it
Project help for STR owners and designers (Nora's existing trade pages)	Not tested by reviews	Lumens and YLighting trade programs, Ferguson showrooms (strong incumbents)

What this costs Nora. It means dropping the 12-17x-markup commodity SKUs: the wood hallway light, the aisle light and the moon lamp. It means absorbing return shipping on items shipped from overseas, and paying for or sourcing listed fixtures. Whether that pencils out belongs to /founder-cfo. Without these changes, Nora is a smaller, slower, review-less Homary.

7. The threat: who could copy fastest, and how

1. **Homary (already there).** It has the same supplier base, free shipping, a "~1 week" in-stock claim on many pendants ([category page](#)), lower prices and thousands of reviews. If Nora finds a winning SKU, Homary probably already lists it or a sibling.
2. **Any Shopify dropshipper, in an afternoon.** Apps such as AliDrop import AliExpress and Alibaba products straight into a Shopify store ([Shopify App Store](#)). Vaxlamp, Articture, Masolighting, Hugbel and Lassola already carry the same cloud and wabi-sabi forms. Nora's catalog has no moat: anything it lists can be copied the same day.
3. **Chinese sellers on Amazon, Walmart and Temu.** They already list the same items at near-factory prices (the \$10 Nordic light, the \$68 moon sconce) with faster US delivery. They win any shopper who image-searches.
4. **Lamps Plus, Lumens and YLighting on the "honest + installer-ready" angle.** If the gap in section 6 proves real, these stores already have the trade desks, return policies and review bases to occupy it. They would only need to add the sculptural Japandi aesthetic, which they can buy from the same factories.

Bottom line for the next skills. /founder-consumer should test the top objections: "Is this the same as the \$70 one on Amazon?", "Where does it ship from, and when?" and "Who pays if I return it?". /founder-pricing should treat about \$125 (lantern median) and about \$195 (cloud pendant median) as the market reference. At current prices, Nora is above the middle of the market without a reason that a shopper can see.

Buyer panel: Nora Furnish (norafurnish.com), an online store for modern and statement lighting and home decor

0 buy · 100 pass (0% buy) out of 100 simulated buyers. Seed 18297, so the same cards can be dealt again.

These are simulated buyers, not customers. Use this to find objections and weak spots, then confirm the big ones with real people before you spend.

By segment

group	buyers	buy rate
Renovating homeowner	40	0%
Affluent design-led homeowner	25	0%
Trade buyer (interior designer, contractor or short-term-rental host)	15	0%
First-home buyer on a budget	20	0%

By buying behaviour

group	buyers	buy rate
Big-retailer loyalist	15	0%
Reads every review	20	0%
Deadline buyer	10	0%
Pinterest and Instagram saver	15	0%
Deal hunter	10	0%
Spec-driven project planner	12	0%
Price checker	18	0%

By income

group	buyers	buy rate
\$100,000 to \$143,000	33	0%
\$143,000 and up	34	0%
under \$100,000	33	0%

Why they pass

reason	buyers	in their words
trust	88	"I've never heard of Nora Furnish, and nothing here tells me the lights are UL listed or that my electrician will be happy to hang them. With my electrician back in three weeks I'm not going to gamble on an unknown store when Wayfair, Lumens or Lowe's have known returns and delivery." (P001) · "I've never heard of Nora

reason	buyers	in their words
		Furnish and nothing here shows reviews, a Trustpilot page or any track record, so I wouldn't put \$360 on a card for a lamp I can't see in person. I'd Google 'is norafurnish legit' first, and with a 6-week wait and return shipping on me, there's no reason to take the risk." (P002)
timing	8	"I need fixtures in hand within a week or two, and 10 to 12 business days for in-stock pieces (6 weeks if made to order) is too slow and too uncertain for my electrician date. On top of that, I've never heard of this store and \$360 is a lot to risk on it." (P011) · "When I need a fixture I need it in hand in a week or two, and 10 to 12 business days is basically three weeks. I've never heard of this store, so I'm not betting a deadline on it." (P018)
price	4	"I've never heard of this store and a paper cloud pendant at \$360 looks like something I can find for a lot less on Amazon or AliExpress. The 10% off doesn't move me, since every store has a first-order code." (P031) · "I just bought a house and I'm watching every dollar. I'd screenshot that paper cloud pendant, run it through Google Lens, and find a lookalike on Amazon or AliExpress for way less than \$360 from a store I've actually heard of." (P059)

Why they buy

reason	buyers	in their words

What would flip a no

- A clearly shown UL/ETL listing on the product page, plus free returns (or at least a prepaid return label) and some proof the store is real, like reviews from verified buyers or a known retailer behind it.
- A lot of independent reviews (Trustpilot, Google, photos from real customers in real rooms), a free return on a change of mind or a sample of the material, and some sign the company has been around for years.
- Hundreds of verified reviews with customer photos on Trustpilot or similar, plus free returns and a faster, firm delivery date.
- Real customer reviews with photos of the actual product, a firm delivery date that beats my electrician date, and free return shipping or a cheap fabric or finish sample before I commit.
- Free returns, or a prepaid return label for anything damaged or not as pictured. Real customer photos and reviews of the pendant hanging in actual homes would help too.
- A trade or designer program with a free sample or swatch, free returns, real reviews with customer photos, and a clear spec sheet (materials, certifications like UL/ETL listing, dimensions). Faster guaranteed delivery would help too.
- Visible UL/ETL listing on the product page, plus a solid pile of independent reviews (Trustpilot or similar) from real buyers with photos, and a clear delivery date that lands before my electrician's visit.
- A solid base of independent reviews (Trustpilot or similar) with real customer photos, plus a way to see the material in person, like a cheap sample or a free-return policy.
- Free return shipping or a clear damage guarantee, real customer photos and reviews, and a faster delivery date. A sale or promo code beyond 10% off would also help.
- A full spec sheet with UL/ETL listing, lumens, CRI, wattage, dimensions and mounting details, plus real reviews with customer photos and a verifiable company address and phone number. Free return shipping on defects or on anything that arrives damaged would help too.
- A guaranteed delivery date within about 7 days on in-stock pieces, plus free returns, or reviews from real buyers with photos showing the quality.
- A pile of real, verifiable customer reviews (Trustpilot or similar) with photos of this light, plus free return shipping or a price clearly below Amazon for the same fixture.

100 buyers gave all four price answers. Run founder-pricing's van_westendorp.py on the answers folder.

Moderator's read (added after tally)

Headline: 0 buy, 100 pass. Every segment, behaviour and income band scored 0%. This matches the live store, which converts about 0.1% of real sessions.

Why they pass: trust 88, timing 8, price 4. Trust is not about price. Buyers will not put \$360 on an unknown store that shows no proof, no UL/ETL listing, no specs and no free returns.

What would flip a no (keyword count across all 100 "would change my mind" answers):

Lever	Buyers who named it
Free returns or a prepaid return label	94
Real reviews with customer photos (on-site plus Trustpilot/Google)	91
Faster or firm, dated delivery	51
UL/ETL listing and a full spec sheet (lumens, CRI, wattage, mounting)	30
A lower price than the same item elsewhere / a bigger discount	28
Samples or swatches / seeing it in person	27
Trade/designer program	6
Phone number, address, years in business	5

Price answers for the \$359.99 pendant (medians): too cheap \$90, bargain \$195, getting expensive \$400, too expensive \$650. These are for an unknown store; /founder-pricing turns them into a range.

Caveat on the pitch: the pitch told buyers this is a store they have not heard of. That is true for almost every new visitor, but it puts trust front of mind. Even read generously, the result says the same thing as the 0.1% real conversion rate: the offer has no proof. Simulated buyers lean agreeable, so 0% is a hard floor signal, not noise.

What to change before spending a dollar on ads: free returns on lighting, a reviews engine with photos, UL/ETL and spec sheets on every lighting product page, and a dated delivery promise. That is /founder-offer's job. More traffic will not fix it.

Buyer panel: Nora Furnish (norafurnish.com), an online store for modern and statement lighting and home decor

0 buy · 20 pass (0% buy) out of 20 simulated buyers. Seed 18297, so the same cards can be dealt again.

These are simulated buyers, not customers. Use this to find objections and weak spots, then confirm the big ones with real people before you spend.

By segment

group	buyers	buy rate
Trade buyer (interior designer, contractor or short-term-rental host)	3	0% (thin)
First-home buyer on a budget	4	0% (thin)
Renovating homeowner	8	0%
Affluent design-led homeowner	5	0% (thin)

By buying behaviour

group	buyers	buy rate
Price checker	4	0% (thin)
Big-retailer loyalist	3	0% (thin)
Reads every review	4	0% (thin)
Pinterest and Instagram saver	3	0% (thin)
Deal hunter	2	0% (thin)
Deadline buyer	2	0% (thin)
Spec-driven project planner	2	0% (thin)

By income

group	buyers	buy rate
\$147,000 and up	7	0% (thin)
under \$94,000	5	0% (thin)
\$94,000 to \$147,000	8	0%

Why they pass

reason	buyers	in their words
trust	14	"I buy lighting from Wayfair, Amazon or Lowe's because I know how returns and delivery work, and I have never heard of Nora Furnish. UL listing numbers and free returns are good signs, but with almost no reviews and 2 to 3 weeks delivery I would stick with the big retailers for my Airbnb refresh." (P002) · "I won't spend

reason	buyers	in their words
		\$360 on a light from a store I've never heard of that has barely any reviews. The UL listing numbers and the free returns are nice, but I'd still be the guinea pig, and I have 40 pendants on my Pinterest board to pick from elsewhere." (P003)
timing	3	"I need fixtures in hand within a week or two for my electrician, and 2 to 3 weeks of delivery doesn't work for that. The UL listing and the returns are reassuring, but I've never heard of this store and it has almost no reviews." (P010) · "The spec sheet, UL numbers and free returns are what I look for, but 2 to 3 weeks delivery with my electrician back in three weeks leaves no slack if it slips or the size is wrong. I will not hang my kitchen schedule on a store I have never heard of." (P016)
price	2	"I'd screenshot that paper cloud pendant, run it through Google Lens and find a near-identical one on Amazon or AliExpress for a fraction of \$360. I've never heard of this store, and there's no trade pricing, so I'd just buy the cheaper one on Prime." (P001) · "I'd screenshot that paper cloud pendant and find a near-identical one on Amazon or AliExpress for a fraction of \$359.99, and I buy for two Airbnb units so I'm not paying a premium for a store I've never heard of. The UL listing and the returns are nice, but they don't close that gap." (P007)
quality	1	"I can't tell from photos whether a paper cloud pendant is actually well made, and I'd screenshot it and find near-identical ones on Amazon or Wayfair for a fraction of \$360. A store I've never heard of with almost no reviews isn't enough to make me skip that comparison, even with free returns." (P015)

Why they buy

reason	buyers	in their words

What would flip a no

- A trade or designer discount (15 to 20% off), or a \$10 to \$15 physical sample or swatch of the paper and fixture finish shipped to me before I commit to the full price.
- A pile of verified reviews from real buyers, or the same fixture listed on Amazon or Wayfair where I already trust the returns.
- A solid pile of independent reviews (Trustpilot, Google, photos from real buyers in real rooms) or seeing the store mentioned by a design blog or renovation forum I trust.
- Real customer photos of installed pieces, close-up video showing the material and finish, or a cheap fabric or material sample I could hold before ordering.
- A bunch of verified reviews with real customer photos of the pendant hanging in a home, or a cheap swatch/sample so I can see the material in person.
- A real discount or trade pricing that brings the price near \$250, plus a handful of verified reviews with photos, or a cheap sample or swatch to check the quality first.
- A trade or multi-unit price clearly below what the lookalikes cost, plus a firm delivery date well inside 2 weeks, and a few verified reviews from other hosts or designers.
- A decent number of verified reviews with real customer photos, or the same pendant at a retailer I already trust.
- A solid pile of independent reviews (Trustpilot or similar) from real buyers with photos, and some history showing the store has been around and handles returns and damage claims properly.
- A guaranteed in-stock delivery date within 7 to 10 days, or a few in-stock pieces that ship in days.
- A firm ship-by date guaranteed to arrive before the electrician visit, plus a free sample or swatch of the paper shade, or a meaningful number of verified reviews with photos of installed fixtures.
- Photos from real buyers with the light hung in an actual kitchen, plus a confirmed delivery date that clears my electrician with a week to spare.

20 buyers gave all four price answers. Run founder-pricing's van_westendorp.py on the answers folder.

Buyer panel: Nora Furnish (norafurnish.com), an online store for modern and statement lighting and home decor

9 buy · 11 pass (45% buy) out of 20 simulated buyers. Seed 18297, so the same cards can be dealt again.

These are simulated buyers, not customers. Use this to find objections and weak spots, then confirm the big ones with real people before you spend.

By segment

group	buyers	buy rate
Affluent design-led homeowner	5	60% (thin)
First-home buyer on a budget	4	50% (thin)
Renovating homeowner	8	38%
Trade buyer (interior designer, contractor or short-term-rental host)	3	33% (thin)

By buying behaviour

group	buyers	buy rate
Deadline buyer	2	100% (thin)
Spec-driven project planner	2	100% (thin)
Reads every review	4	75% (thin)
Deal hunter	2	50% (thin)
Pinterest and Instagram saver	3	33% (thin)
Price checker	4	0% (thin)
Big-retailer loyalist	3	0% (thin)

By income

group	buyers	buy rate
under \$94,000	5	60% (thin)
\$147,000 and up	7	57% (thin)
\$94,000 to \$147,000	8	25%

Why they pass

reason	buyers	in their words
price	6	"I'd screenshot that paper cloud pendant, run it through Google Lens and find a near-identical one on Amazon or Wayfair for a lot less, and I already have Prime. Sixty reviews on a store I've never heard of isn't enough for me to pay a premium over a lookalike I can get in two days." (P001) · "The reviews, UL number

reason	buyers	in their words
		and free returns are reassuring, but a white paper cloud pendant is a look I can probably find on Amazon for a lot less. I'd pin it to my dining room board and keep comparing." (P003)
habit	4	"I buy lighting from Wayfair, Amazon or Lowe's because I know how returns and delivery work there, and I've never heard of Nora Furnish. The UL listing, free returns and the trade discount are good, but 60 reviews on a one-person store isn't enough for me to switch when I'm watching my budget." (P002) · "The reviews with real photos, the UL number and free returns calm me down a lot, and \$249 isn't crazy. But I'd pin it to my dining room board with the other 40 and wait until the room actually comes together, so I wouldn't buy this month." (P005)
trust	1	"The returns, UL listing and photo reviews are all reassuring, but I buy lighting from Wayfair, West Elm or Lumens because I know how a return or a damaged box gets handled. A paper cloud pendant from a one-person shop in Oklahoma is not something I would put in my cart this week." (P008)

Why they buy

reason	buyers	in their words
trust	8	"Free 30-day returns, real buyer photos and a UL number make it low-risk to order one for an Airbnb refresh, and the 15% trade rate helps. I'd start with a single piece, not a whole order." (P004) · "I'd normally bounce off a store I've never heard of, but 60 verified reviews with real install photos, the same rating on Google, a UL number I can look up and free 30-day returns answer my 'is it legit' question. I'd buy one pendant for the room that bugs me most and see how it goes before doing more." (P009)
price	1	"With the 15% trade discount it lands around \$212, the UL number is listed and free 30-day returns take the risk out, so I'd order one to see it in person. If it checks out I might use them on a rental." (P006)

What would flip a no

- Proof that it's a different product from the Amazon lookalikes (not the same factory item rebranded), plus a cheap sample or swatch I can hold, or a trade price that gets it close to Amazon pricing.
- A trade-account price clearly below Wayfair or Amazon for the same style, plus a UL listing number I can check myself and proof that returns on a damaged fixture are handled without a fight.
- Proof that it is clearly better made than the Amazon lookalikes (side-by-side photos, materials, how the paper and LED hold up after a year), or a price nearer \$180.
- The dining room being painted and ready, plus a review photo of this exact pendant over a table in a room like mine. Or a cheaper sample of the paper material.
- A trade price under about \$120 for this style, or proof that it's a different build from the lookalikes (not just 'inspected'), plus a bulk price for 4 or more units across my two rentals.
- Seeing the same pendant on Wayfair, Amazon or Lumens with a few hundred reviews, or a designer I follow showing it installed in a real home.
- Photos of this exact pendant over a kitchen island from a real buyer, plus a sizing recommendation for my kitchen. If the shade were a more durable material and the price were under about \$200, I'd order it before the electrician comes.
- Seeing the same pendant on Wayfair or Amazon with a few hundred reviews, or the store sending me a cheap physical sample of the shade to hold up in my room first.
- Proof this isn't the generic factory piece, such as a cheap sample of the paper and diffuser, or a side-by-side with the Amazon version showing a real difference in materials and light quality.
- A side-by-side showing what makes this one different from the cheap lookalikes (materials, LED quality, the sampling and inspection), or a price closer to \$150, or a bigger discount for buying several fixtures for the house.

- A first-order promo code or sale bringing it to about \$190 or less, plus me verifying the UL number on UL's own site.

Buyers say they would buy **1.0 times** in the first month on average.

20 buyers gave all four price answers. Run founder-pricing's `van_westendorp.py` on the answers folder.

Offer: Nora Furnish

Method: the Offers lens (a summary of the published framework in *\$100M Offers*; not the author's words).
Inputs: panel v1 (100 buyers), board.md, numbers.json, storefront audit, price history.

1. The problem list (buyer's words, from the panel and the audit)

Before buying 1. "I've never heard of this store, is it legit?" (88/100 panel buyers passed on trust) 2. "There are no real reviews." (91/100 asked for verified reviews with photos; the site's 838 reviews are imported from AliExpress and shown as "Verified Buyer", 0 of them verified) 3. "I can find the same light cheaper on Amazon or AliExpress." (Google Lens; catalog photos and SKUs come from Dazuma, Baskoraa and AliExpress listings) 4. "The 'sale' is fake." (compare-at prices that were never charged; a countdown that rolls from Fall Sale into Halloween Sale) 5. "Who am I even paying?" (email only, no phone, no name, address hidden in a policy page) 6. "Is it UL listed? My electrician won't hang it otherwise." (30/100; no listing shown on any sampled product, some E14/220V variants) 7. "I can't judge the quality or size from photos." (27/100 wanted samples or real photos) 8. "Too many popups and codes; the list price isn't real." 9. "\$360 for a brand nobody knows is a lot."

During 10. "10-12 business days, or 6 weeks, is too long; my electrician is booked." (51/100 wanted a faster or firm date) 11. "'In stock' but it ships from overseas in 3 weeks." (all products show "In stock", including 337 made-to-order) 12. "I don't know when it will arrive."

After 13. "Return shipping on a big fixture would cost a fortune." (94/100 asked for free returns or a prepaid label) 14. "It arrived broken, now what?" 15. "Integrated LED dies after a month and the warranty is 30 days." 16. "The FAQ says no warranty and also a 30-day warranty." 17. "I need help installing or sizing it." 18. "Trade buyers need pricing, specs and repeatable supply." (6/100)

2. Solutions, scored (value to buyer 1-5, cost to deliver 1-5; keep high value, low cost)

#	Solution	Kills	Value	Cost	Keep?
A	Remove imported reviews from "Verified Buyer" display; turn on Judge.me post-purchase requests with photo incentive (not tied to rating)	1, 2	5	1	Yes (legal must-do)
B	Clear every compare-at price that was not charged for 30+ days; one honest promotion per quarter	4, 8	4	1	Yes (legal must-do)
C	Human contact: chat (Shopify Inbox, free) + Google Voice number, founder name/photo, legal entity and address in footer	1, 5	5	1	Yes
D	Free 30-day returns on lighting with prepaid label to a US address (Edmond, OK); resell open-box	13	5	2	Yes
E	Arrives damaged: photo, free replacement, no return needed (supplier-backed)	14	4	1	Yes
F	Dated delivery window on every page and at checkout ("Arrives Oct 22-28"); 10% back if late	10, 11, 12	4	2	Yes
G	Curate to UL/ETL-listed hardwired fixtures, show listing number; delist 220V/E14 variants	6	5	3	Yes (curation, not cost per order)

#	Solution	Kills	Value	Cost	Keep?
H	Full spec table on every lighting page (lumens, watts, CRI, CCT, dimmer type, base, IP, weight)	6, 7	4	2	Yes
I	1-year replacement warranty on lighting (LED and driver)	15, 16	4	2	Yes (~2-3% of revenue)
J	Free sizing help: room photo → size and hanging height in 1 business day	7, 17	4	1	Yes (founder time)
K	Own photography of the 30 advertised hero SKUs from inspected samples	3, 7	5	3	Yes (startup cost \$3,000)
L	Price hero SKUs within reach of identical listings elsewhere (no 12-17x markups on Lens-able items)	3, 9	5	3 (margin)	Yes
M	US-stocked "Ships in 2 days" line of 10-20 best sellers	10	5	5	Later (after 30+ orders prove demand)
N	Material samples / swatches (\$15, credited on order)	7	3	3	Trade only
O	Trade program: 15% trade price, spec sheets, project quotes	18	4	2	Yes (already have pages)
P	\$250 design membership	-	1	4	Cut (no proof yet)
Q	Stacked codes (WELCOME10, COMEBACK10, 5%, Member 20%, "Kevin 15", popups)	-	1	4	Cut

3. The stack

Name: The Nora Lighting Promise

Core: a curated line of about 150 pendants, chandeliers and wall lights, each sampled and inspected, with full specs and a listed safety certification on every hardwired fixture. Described as the outcome: "the light you pictured, the right size, installed by your electrician without a surprise."

Bonuses (each kills one objection): 1. Free sizing help within one business day (kills "I can't judge size or fit"). 2. Electrician-ready spec sheet and install guide PDF with every lighting product (kills "will my electrician install it"). 3. Bundle pricing: 2+ pieces from the same collection save 10% (lifts AOV for islands, hallways and stairwells; replaces every other code).

Guarantee: free 30-day returns on lighting (prepaid label), a free replacement if it arrives damaged, a 1-year warranty on LEDs and drivers, and 10% back if it arrives after the dated window.

Urgency (true only): the holiday delivery cutoff. "Order by Nov 24 for delivery before Dec 20" (set from carrier transit, see ops.md). No countdowns, no "only 3 left".

What is cut: imported "Verified Buyer" reviews, fake compare-at prices, rolling sales, the membership, the per-product popup, every code except bundle pricing and one welcome offer.

4. Cost of the stack (per order, at \$350 AOV; added to numbers.json)

Item	Assumption (est.)	Per order
Free returns label	8% of orders return × \$35 domestic label for a large box	\$2.80

Item	Assumption (est.)	Per order
Late-delivery credit	15% late × 10% of \$350	\$5.25
1-year warranty replacements	2.5% of revenue	\$8.75
Damaged-on-arrival replacements	Supplier-backed; est. net 1% of revenue	\$3.50
Discount allowance	Falls from est. 8% to 5% (one bundle offer + one welcome)	saves \$10.50
Net added cost		≈ \$9.80

Startup items (in numbers.json): samples and inspection of 30 hero SKUs, own photography, trademark, review-request setup.

5. Value equation, before → after (1-10)

Element	Before	After	What moves it
Dream outcome (the statement light in my room)	6	7	Curated line, sizing help
Perceived likelihood (it is real, safe and as pictured)	1	4	Honest reviews, UL/ETL, human contact, free returns; still capped by few real reviews
Time to result	3	4	Dated delivery window, late credit; still 2-3 weeks from overseas
Effort and sacrifice	3	6	Free returns, damage replacement, spec sheet, no code-hunting

6. Re-test result (panel-v2: 20 buyers, same seed 18297, same \$359.99 price)

0 buy · 20 pass (0%), against 0 of 100 for v1. Reasons: trust 14, timing 3, price 2, quality 1.

What dropped: almost nobody raised free returns, UL listing or specs as the blocker. Several said the listing numbers and returns were "good signs" but not enough.

What remains: - **"Brand new store with hardly any reviews."** Copy cannot fix this. Only real orders fix it. - **"I'd Google Lens it and buy the lookalike on Amazon for a fraction."** Product sameness plus markup. - **"2-3 weeks is too slow."** - Wanted: samples, trade pricing, in-stock items shipping in days.

Plain reading: the offer was not the only problem. The product sourcing (identical, Lens-able items at 3-17x markup) and the absence of real proof are. Nothing in the copy moves a buyer until there are real reviews and either (a) prices near the identical listings or (b) products a buyer cannot find elsewhere. That points to: price hero SKUs honestly (pricing.md), seed the first 20-30 real orders through channels where trust is borrowed (marketplaces, trade, local), and build a small US-stocked or exclusive line once demand is proven (ops.md, launch.md).

Panel answers are simulated research, not customer quotes.

Pricing: Nora Furnish

Inputs: panel v1 (100 buyers, \$359.99 pitch), panel v3 (20 buyers, target-state store at \$249), competitors.csv, numbers.json, price-history.md. Simulated price answers pick what to test; they are not proof.

1. What buyers said (Van Westendorp)

	Today's store (v1, n=100)	Target-state store (v3, n=20)
Point of marginal cheapness (PMC)	\$121	\$90
Indifference price (IPP)	\$249	\$160
Point of marginal expensiveness (PME)	\$449	\$350
Median "too expensive"	\$650	\$420

The acceptable range for a statement paper pendant is roughly **\$120-\$450**. Buyers anchor on the price they are shown: v3 saw \$249 and its whole curve moved down. Treat \$250-\$350 as the band that does not trigger "too expensive" for most buyers.

2. What competitors charge (links in competitors.csv)

Comparable	Low	Middle	High
Cloud / wabi-sabi pendant	Etsy shade \$42; Walmart look-alikes	Vaxlamp \$205 ("was \$342"); Etsy organic cloud \$474	Articture \$499+
Outdoor wall lantern	Home Depot marketplace \$40-\$79; Homary \$60-\$70	AllModern \$99-\$118; Destination Lighting \$96-\$308 (ships in 1 business day)	Rejuvenation \$349-\$529; RH \$395
Moon wall lamp	AliExpress \$33-\$106; Amazon \$68-\$90	-	Nora today \$185
Nordic wood hallway ceiling light	Walmart \$10-\$11	-	Nora today \$178-\$202
Design-store pendants (branded, US stock)	Article \$199	CB2 \$249; Lulu and Georgia \$225+	Schoolhouse \$299-\$449; Lightology \$695+

Nora's commodity items sit 2-17x above identical listings that a buyer finds in one image search. Its statement pieces (\$250-\$450) sit in the same band as Article, CB2 and Schoolhouse. Those stores have brands, US stock and years of reviews, which Nora does not have yet.

3. What the business needs (per piece; White Paper Cloud Pendant 23.6", recorded cost \$38.88, plus estimated \$25 shipping)

Price	Contribution before acquisition	After a \$120 acquisition cost
\$199	\$89	-\$31
\$249	\$130	\$10

Price	Contribution before acquisition	After a \$120 acquisition cost
\$279	\$155	\$35
\$299	\$172	\$52
\$359.99 (today)	\$222	\$102

Costs deducted: 2.9% + \$0.30 card fees, 10% refund allowance, 5% discount allowance, \$9.80 for the guarantee stack (offer.md). Below about \$230, a paid-acquired single-piece order loses money. The order-level model (numbers.json, \$350 order value) is what the CFO uses.

4. The decision

Price rule (replaces the September/October across-the-board markups): 1. **Commodity, Lens-able items** (night lights, Nordic wood flush mounts, rope lights, solar items; anything sold under \$30 on Walmart, Amazon or AliExpress): **delist from Nora**. They cannot carry a premium brand. If kept, price within 1.3x of the lowest identical US listing, never with a compare-at. 2. **Statement pieces** (sculptural pendants, chandeliers, wall lights a buyer cannot find identical on Amazon): price at **landed cost × 4-6, inside \$250-\$450**, at or below the design-store band (CB2, Schoolhouse, Lulu and Georgia). 3. **No compare-at prices** unless the item actually sold at that price for 30+ days. 4. **One price, everywhere**. No rolling sales, no per-product popup codes.

Hero price: White Paper Cloud Pendant 23.6" at \$279 (was \$359.99). It sits between the v1 indifference price (\$249) and the v3 marginal-expensiveness point (\$350), below Articture (\$499) and Etsy (\$474), above Vaxlamp (\$205), and keeps \$155 per piece before acquisition.

5. The ladder

Rung	What	Price logic	Reason to step up
Good	One piece	List price	-
Better	Pair or trio from one collection (kitchen island, hallway, stairwell)	10% off the 2nd and later pieces (the only standing discount)	Islands and hallways need 2-3 lights; this lifts the average order toward the \$350+ the model needs
Best	Room set: pendant(s) + matching sconces + free sizing plan	10% bundle + free layout help	One decision for a whole room; highest order value
Trade	Designers, contractors, rental hosts (verified)	15% off list, project quotes	Repeat volume

6. Opening offer (true, dated, no fake urgency)

Relaunch week: free sizing plan plus 10% off a first order over \$250, for 14 days from relaunch, ending on a stated date. After that only the bundle and trade pricing remain. The holiday delivery cutoff ("order by Nov 24 to arrive before Dec 20", set from real transit times in ops.md) is the only urgency message.

7. What to test with real buyers

Test	How	Success line
\$279 vs \$329 on the Cloud pendant	Google Shopping split: two equivalent ad groups, or alternate weeks; same page	At least 300 clicks per arm; the arm with higher contribution per click wins (orders × contribution ÷

Test	How	Success line
	otherwise	clicks)
Bundle discount 10% vs free sizing plan only	Alternate weeks on island-pendant pages	Share of orders with 2+ pieces; target $\geq 30\%$
Trade 15%	Outreach to 30 OKC designers and STR hosts	3 trade accounts placing a first order within 30 days

8. Price objections to answer in marketing (panel quotes, research only, never testimonials)

1. "I'd screenshot that paper cloud pendant, run it through Google Lens, and find a lookalike on Amazon or AliExpress for way less than \$360 from a store I've actually heard of." (v1, P059)
2. "A paper cloud pendant at \$360 looks like something I can find for a lot less on Amazon or AliExpress. The 10% off doesn't move me, since every store has a first-order code." (v1, P031)
3. "With the 15% trade discount it lands around \$212, the UL number is listed and free 30-day returns take the risk out, so I'd order one to see it in person." (v3, P006, a buyer who said yes)

If the price changes, update `numbers.json` and re-run `/founder-cfo` (done; see `cfo.md`).

Price history evidence (Shopify orders vs current variant prices, 2026-10-08)

The same products were sold at much lower prices in August 2026. Since then they have been repriced upward (bulk update on 2026-10-07 00:56 UTC across products), mostly with a compare-at ("was") price about 18% above the new price.

Product	Sold at (order, date)	Price now	Compare-at now	Unit cost	Now ÷ then	Markup now
Rechargeable Motion Sensor LED Night Light	\$17.99 (#1831019, Aug 21)	\$49.99	\$58.99	\$4.18	2.8x	12.0x
Nordic Wood Round Hallway Ceiling Light	\$39.99 (#1831020, Aug 22)	\$177.99-\$201.99	\$210.99-\$238.99	\$9.43-\$11.79	4.5x	17x
Modern LED Aisle Surface Ceiling Light	\$36.99 (#1831017, Aug 11)	\$123.99	\$146.99	\$8.66	3.4x	14x
Type C Rechargeable Table Lamp	\$44.99 (#1831024, Aug 26)	\$115.99 (archived)	-	\$10.30	2.6x	11x
Outdoor LED Rope Tube String Lights (23 ft)	\$31.99 (#1831021, Aug 24)	\$75.99	\$90.99	\$5.72	2.4x	13x
Rechargeable Sensor Ceiling Light with Timer	\$93.99 (#1831022, Aug 24)	\$80.99 (1 pc)	\$95.99	\$26.84	~0.9x	3.0x
Motion Sensor LED Stair Light	\$861.99 (#1831029, Sep 22; big kit variant)	from \$175.99	-	\$54.87-\$376.66	n/a	2.3-3.2x

Shipping carriers on recent orders: YunExpress, SFC Service, WANB Express, "ST" (China cross-border lines). Order-to-delivery observed: 7-15 days for small August items, 14 days (stair light), 21 days (vanity picture light).

Why this matters

- 1. Compare-at prices that were never charged are fake reference prices.** The FTC's Guides Against Deceptive Pricing (16 CFR Part 233) say a former price must be one the item was openly and actively offered at, in good faith, for a reasonably substantial period. Several states (e.g. California Bus. & Prof. Code §17501) restrict "was" prices to prices charged in the prior 90 days. Showing "\$146.99 → \$123.99" on an item that sold for \$36.99 in August is the textbook case. Remove compare-at prices store-wide unless the item genuinely sold at that price recently. (Not legal advice; a lawyer confirms.)
- 2. A 12-17x markup on a commodity item is visible to buyers.** The same items are a Google Lens search away (see competitors.md). That is the "trust" objection 88 of 100 panel buyers raised.

Unit economics: Nora Furnish (online lighting store, supplier-fulfilled from China)

Every number below comes from the input file. Nothing is looked up or guessed.

One order

line	per order
Price	\$350.00
Product cost from supplier (est. 25% of order value; recorded costs run 7-44% of current prices, 14% on the \$279 hero pendant)	-\$87.50
Supplier shipping China to US per order (est.; confirm whether Shopify unit cost includes it)	-\$30.00
Shopify Payments 2.9% + \$0.30	-\$10.45
Refunds allowance (est. 10% of orders refunded and written off; today 4 of 14)	-\$35.00
Discounts (bundle 10% on extra pieces + one welcome offer; est. 5% of order value)	-\$17.50
Guarantee stack: free return labels, late-delivery credit, 1-year warranty, damage replacements (offer.md)	-\$20.30
Blended customer acquisition cost per order (est. \$120; paid ads untested)	-\$120.00
Contribution (what each order leaves to pay the fixed costs)	\$29.25 (8%)

The margin that matters

Fixed costs: \$364 a month (Shopify Basic plan \$39, Apps: Judge.me reviews, delivery-date, email (est.) \$100, Google Workspace, domain, Google Voice (est.) \$25, Ongoing QC samples and photography (est.) \$200).

- **Break-even: 1 orders a day.** Below that you lose money every month.
- **Profit margin at your plan** (1 a day): **5%** of every sale, after every cost.
- Capacity: 20 a day.

Year 1, month by month

month	orders a day	revenue	profit	cumulative (after \$5,000 startup)
1	0	\$525	-\$320	-\$5,320
2	0	\$1,050	-\$276	-\$5,596
3	0	\$1,575	-\$232	-\$5,829
4	0	\$2,625	-\$145	-\$5,973
5	0	\$3,675	-\$57	-\$6,030
6	0	\$4,725	\$31	-\$5,999
7	1	\$5,775	\$119	-\$5,881
8	1	\$6,825	\$206	-\$5,674

month	orders a day	revenue	profit	cumulative (after \$5,000 startup)
9	1	\$7,875	\$294	-\$5,380
10	1	\$8,925	\$382	-\$4,998
11	1	\$9,450	\$426	-\$4,573
12	1	\$10,500	\$514	-\$4,059

- **Year 1 operating profit: \$941** on \$63,525 of revenue.
- After the \$5,000 startup spend: -\$4,059.
- Startup money earned back: not within year 1.
- Cash you need before it pays for itself: **\$6,030**.

What if

scenario	margin at plan	break-even a day	year 1 profit
Base plan	5%	1	\$941
Price -10%	-6%	never	-\$5,412
Volume -20%	4%	1	-\$121
Unit costs +15%	-9%	never	-\$7,792

Red flags

- The startup spend is not earned back within year 1.

Marketing: Nora Furnish

Evidence used: panel v1 (0/100 buy, trust 88), v2 (0/20 after the honest offer), v3 target state (9/20 buy), competitors.md, pricing.md, numbers.json, Shopify traffic data. **Rule for everything below: no ad money until store-fixes.md Week 1 and Week 2 are done.** Traffic onto today's store buys refunds and Merchant Center risk, not customers.

1. Positioning

- For design-minded homeowners finishing a room, who can't tell which online lighting stores are real, Nora Furnish is the lighting shop that shows you everything up front (where it ships from, when it arrives, the UL listing, free returns), unlike the look-alike stores that hide it. (recommended)* Evidence: the buyers who said yes in v3 named exactly these proofs ("a UL number I can look up and free 30-day returns answer..."). The competitor gap: no look-alike DTC store states origin and lead time up front (competitors.md §6).
- For people with a kitchen island or stairwell to light, Nora Furnish sizes it for you, free, and sells the set.* Evidence: sizing help and spec sheets reduced effort objections; the bundle ladder lifts order value.
- For Oklahoma designers and rental hosts, a local lighting source with trade pricing and project quotes.* Evidence: trade buyers bought in v3 because of the 15% rate; local showrooms (LifeStyles Edmond, Andrews Lighting Gallery OKC) are the comparison.

Use 1 for the site and Google; 3 as a parallel direct-outreach channel.

2. Channels (pick three)

Channel	Why it fits	Cost	How you know it worked
Google organic + free Shopping listings	The only channel that has converted (1,889 sessions, 7 orders, 0.37%). 31 buyer-intent guides already exist.	\$0 + time	Organic orders per month; guides → product clicks
Google Shopping ads on 20-30 hero SKUs (standard Shopping, not broad Performance Max)	Buyers searching "cloud pendant light", "staircase chandelier" have intent; ads show price and image up front, so the honest price rule matters	\$30/day test = ~\$900/month	CAC ≤ \$100; contribution per click > 0
Local trade outreach (OKC/Edmond)	30 designers, builders and STR hosts; trust borrowed from a face and a phone call	Founder time + samples	3 trade accounts with a first order in 30 days
Pinterest organic (support)	15% of buyers are savers; the Pinterest tag is already installed	Time	Saves → site sessions

Not doing now: Meta/Instagram ads (cold audiences and this store's trust gap; past Facebook traffic was 187 add-to-carts and 0 orders, bot-like), TikTok, influencers and Performance Max on the full catalog. Revisit after 30 real reviews.

3. The most you can pay for a customer

Contribution per order before acquisition = \$350 – \$87.50 – \$30 – \$10.45 – \$35 – \$17.50 – \$20.30 = **\$149.25** (numbers.json). The panel shows about 1 purchase per buyer in the first month, and repeat buying is unproven. So the **ceiling is ~\$149 per first order; target ≤ \$100** to keep ~\$49 per order. At today's 0.15% conversion and ~\$1 per Shopping click, CAC would be ~\$670. **Conversion has to reach ~1% before ads pay.** That is why fixes come first.

4. Ten hooks (each answers a panel objection)

#	Objection	Hook (format)
1	"Is it legit?"	"Hi, I'm Joe. I run Nora Furnish from Edmond, Oklahoma. Call or text me." (About/hero, short video)
2	"No real reviews"	"Every review here is from someone who bought from us. We're new, so there aren't many yet. Here's why we won't fake them." (PDP banner)
3	"Cheaper on Amazon"	"Yes, you can find look-alikes for less. Here's what \$279 buys you that they don't: a UL listing, a 1-year warranty and free returns." (Shopping ad/PDP)
4	"Will my electrician install it?"	"Electrician-ready: UL listing number, spec sheet and install guide on every light." (Ad headline)
5	"Return shipping costs a fortune"	"Free returns on every light. Prepaid label, no restocking fee." (Ad description/PDP row)
6	"When will it arrive?"	"You'll see your delivery date before you pay. Late? 10% back." (PDP)
7	"Can't judge the size"	"Send a photo of your island. We'll tell you the size and hanging height by tomorrow." (Pinterest pin/guide CTA)
8	"Where does it ship from?"	"Most pieces ship from our partner factories overseas. We tell you that up front, plus the exact transit time." (FAQ/PDP)
9	"It arrived broken"	"Broken on arrival? Send a photo. A new one ships free, no need to send the old one back." (Post-purchase email)
10	Trade	"Designers and rental hosts: 15% trade pricing, project quotes in 1 business day." (Outreach email/LinkedIn)

5. 30-day campaign (relaunch date: Monday, October 26, 2026)

Date	Channel	What goes out
Oct 12 (L-14)	Site	Week-1 legal fixes live (reviews, compare-at, Best Sellers, claims). No promotion yet.
Oct 13	Google Merchant Center	Re-sync feed without compare-at "sale" prices; check for policy warnings
Oct 14	Email (28 customer records)	Plain founder note: "We're changing how we run Nora. Free returns, real reviews only."
Oct 15-16	Trade	Build list: 30 OKC/Edmond designers, builders, STR hosts (Houzz, Instagram, Airbnb host groups)
Oct 19 (L-7)	Site	Week-2 fixes live: contact, chat, phone, delivery dates, nav cut, PDP assurance row
Oct 20	Blog	Publish "How to size a pendant over a kitchen island (send us your photo)" with hook 7
Oct 21	Pinterest	10 pins from existing guides linking to hero SKUs

Date	Channel	What goes out
Oct 22	Trade	First 10 outreach emails (hook 10)
Oct 23	Google Ads	Build Shopping campaign: 20-30 hero SKUs, exact product titles, \$30/day, not live yet
Oct 26 (L)	Site + Ads + Email	Relaunch: Shopping ads live; relaunch offer (free sizing plan + 10% off first order over \$250, ends Nov 8); founder video on About
Oct 27	Trade	10 more outreach emails; offer 1 loaner/sample for designers
Oct 28	Pinterest	5 pins: island, stairwell, entry sets (bundle ladder)
Oct 30	Review	First weekly numbers review (section 6)
Nov 2	Blog	"UL vs ETL vs CE: what your electrician means" (hook 4)
Nov 3	Trade	Last 10 outreach emails; follow-ups
Nov 5	Ads	Cut SKUs with 100+ clicks and 0 add-to-carts; raise bids on winners
Nov 6	Email	Holiday cutoff notice: "Order by Nov 24 for delivery before Dec 20" (from ops transit times)
Nov 8	Site	Relaunch offer ends on the stated date (no extension)
Nov 9	Review	Day-14 review: CAC, conversion, refunds, reviews
Nov 11 (L+16)	Pinterest/Blog	Post the first real customer photo review (with permission)

Nothing new to say? Post behind-the-scenes: unboxing and inspecting a sample, comparing a \$10 look-alike with a listed fixture, a supplier certificate check, a packing test.

6. Numbers to watch weekly (internal and bot traffic excluded)

Number	Today	"Change something" level
Mobile add-to-cart rate	1.7%	below 3% after week 2 → work on the PDP and price, not ads
Purchase conversion	~0.15%	below 0.7% by day 30 → pause ads, fix the offer
Google Shopping CAC	untested	above \$120 over 300+ clicks → cut SKUs or pause
Refund rate	4 of 14	above 10% → stop selling that SKU, check supplier QC
Real reviews collected	0 verified	under 10 by day 45 → call customers personally

No fake reviews, follower counts or "as seen on". Panel quotes are research, never ad copy.

Brand: Nora Furnish

Scope note: the owner already has norafurnish.com and is keeping the name, so this skips name generation and domains. It covers the one legal flag, the voice, and what to change visually on the live theme (nora-v5-mobile-menu, read from the theme files).

1. One legal flag on the name (not a rename recommendation)

Nora Lighting, Inc. (Commerce, CA; about 150 staff, 30+ years in lighting) holds USPTO registrations for **NORA LIGHTING** in Class 11, lighting goods: Reg. No. 2939989 (registered 2005, renewed) and Reg. No. 5939753 (2019, stylized), plus NORA NSPEC LIGHTING (Reg. No. 5076214). Sources: [Justia 2939989](#), [Nora Lighting marks](#). "Nora Furnish" selling lighting puts the shared dominant word **NORA** on the same goods. That is the textbook setup for a likelihood-of-confusion claim, and a Google search for "Nora Furnish lighting" already returns Nora Lighting pages.

What to do: before spending on photography, packaging or ads under this name, spend about \$300-\$500 on a trademark attorney's clearance opinion (search USPTO at <https://tmsearch.uspto.gov>, Classes 11 and 35). If the opinion is bad, a light-touch fix keeps the domain: lead with a distinct mark (e.g. a sub-brand for the lighting line) and use "Nora Furnish" as the store name. Not legal advice.

2. Promise, tagline and voice

Promise (what a customer can count on every time): *You'll know exactly what you're getting, where it ships from and when it arrives, and if it's not right, it goes back free.*

Tagline options: 1. *Statement lighting, no surprises.* (recommended; it answers the trust objection directly) 2. *Light the room you pictured.* 3. *Sized for your room. Listed for your electrician.*

Voice: plain, warm, exact.

Trait	Do	Don't
Plain	"Ships from our partner factory overseas. Arrives Oct 22 to 28."	"Artisan-crafted in our workshop" (not true)
Warm	"Send a photo of your island and I'll tell you what size fits."	"Elevate your space with timeless luxury"
Exact	"23.6 in wide, 1,800 lumens, 3000K, UL listed (E123456)"	"Bright, warm glow"; "2700K 3999K"

Before → after (from today's homepage): - Before: *"The First Days of Fall Sale. Shorter Days, Warmer Rooms. Shop the Sale"* (stale sale, the button goes to Best Sellers) - After: *"Statement lighting, no surprises. Free returns, real delivery dates, UL-listed fixtures. Shop ceiling lights"*

3. What to change visually (from the live theme settings and sections)

Area	Today (theme files)	Change to	Why
Fonts	Settings: Roboto Serif Light headings with very wide letter-spacing (16) + Montserrat body (spacing 5). Layout	Two families: keep Fraunces (display, already loaded) for headings and Inter for body/UI; drop Roboto Serif, Montserrat and Lora. Heading letter-spacing 0-2, body 0.	Fewer fonts read as more premium and load faster. Wide-tracked light serifs look generic

Area	Today (theme files)	Change to	Why
	also loads Fraunces, Lora and Inter from Google Fonts: 5 families.		"template luxury" and are hard to read on mobile.
Colour	Pure white background, #1c1c1c buttons, gold #c9a36a for ratings and chat, terracotta #a65440 sale accent	Warm paper #FBF8F3 background, ink #1F1B16 text and primary buttons (contrast 16.2:1, passes WCAG AA and AAA), brass #9A7B4F accent for badges and icons only (3.7:1 on paper: large text and icons only), and a darker bronze #7A5F3A for text links (5.6:1, passes AA). Retire the red-terracotta sale accent with the fake sales.	Lighting photographs warmer on an off-white; one accent, used sparingly, looks curated.
Cards	Custom CSS <code>.card {border-radius: 30px}</code> ; square images; secondary image on hover off	Radius 4-8px; turn on the secondary image and make it the light switched on (or installed in a room)	30px pill cards look playful, not high-ticket. For lighting, "off vs on" is the most persuasive image you have.
Homepage	17 sections; countdown bar first; Halloween inflatables tabs; trust strip last; hard-coded "Verified Buyer" photo wall	8 sections: hero (one room, lit) → trust strip (free returns · delivery date · UL listed · talk to a person) → shop by room → day-to-night kitchen slider (keep, it's the best thing on the site) → 8 hero products → founder note with photo → guides → newsletter	Today's page leads with a fake countdown and Halloween; a buyer of a \$300 light needs proof first.
Navigation	15 top-level items + top bar + pills	Ceiling · Wall · Lamps · Outdoor · Trade · Guides (Home decor folded into one menu if kept)	Decision fatigue; the brand reads as a general store.
Product page	Green "In stock" on everything; assurance row "Secure checkout / Encrypted on Shopify"; supplier photos; Bundle & Save 10/15%	Delivery window ("Arrives Oct 22-28"); assurance row = delivery date · free returns · 1-year warranty · chat; a spec table above the fold on desktop; own photos for hero SKUs	Puts the four things buyers asked for where they decide.
Swatches	<code>color_swatch_config</code> still holds furniture colours ("Beige Gray Seat + Gold Base", "White Door"...)	Trim to lighting finishes (black, brass, chrome, white, wood, glass, paper)	Leftover furniture data; sloppy swatches undercut "curated".
Overlays	Newsletter popup + per-product 10% popup + countdown bar + cookie banner on first visit	One delayed welcome offer (exit intent or 30s on mobile); remove nf-offer-popup and the countdown	Stacked overlays hurt mobile and signal discount-store.
Logo/favicon	<code>CLEAN_FAVICON</code> image	Keep; check the 32px icon reads as a single mark, not tiny text	-

4. The first five touchpoints

1. **Homepage hero:** one real lit room, the tagline, the trust strip directly underneath.
2. **Packaging:** supplier boxes can't be changed yet. Add a printed insert in the shipment, or emailed at delivery: "Inspected for Nora. Questions? Text [number]. Free returns: scan here."
3. **Order confirmation:** the delivery window in the first line, where it ships from, and who to text.
4. **First social post:** "Here's how we check a light before we list it" (a sample on the bench, with the listing number checked on UL Product iQ).

5. **Reply to the first complaint:** within 4 business hours, a named person, the fix offered before they ask (replacement or prepaid label), then a follow-up when it's resolved.

No copied competitor names, logos or taglines. Fraunces and Inter are free under the SIL Open Font License (Google Fonts).

Relaunch plan: Nora Furnish

Not a new launch: the store is live and has ~12 real orders. This is a **relaunch of an honest, focused store**, with a cheap real-world test before any real ad budget. Target relaunch: **Monday, October 26, 2026**. Owner = Joe (the founder) unless noted; "Claude" = changes Claude can make through the Shopify Admin API if the owner says go.

1. Test before you spend

The test: after the Week-1 and Week-2 fixes (store-fixes.md), run Google Shopping on **10 hero SKUs** at honest prices (pricing.md rule) for **14 days at \$25/day (\$350 total)**, plus 30 trade outreach emails.

Success line, written before running: - At least **350 clicks** and **3+ orders** ($\geq 0.85\%$ click-to-order) with blended $CAC \leq \$117$, i.e. $\$350 \div 3$. - Mobile add-to-cart rate $\geq 3\%$ (today 1.7%). - Zero refunds for "not as described" in the first 30 days after delivery. - Trade: **2+ accounts** opened and 1 first order.

Compare with the panel: the simulated panel says today's store converts 0% and the target state up to 45% (an upper bound, since models lean agreeable). Real conversion today is ~0.15%. If the test lands under 0.5% conversion, trust the real buyers: go back to pricing (Lens-able items) and offer (reviews, US stock), not to bigger budgets.

2. Countdown (today Thursday Oct 8 → relaunch Mon Oct 26)

Week	Task	Owner	Deadline	Critical path?
Oct 8-11	Decide the keep list: ~150-300 lighting SKUs (catalog summary in data/)	Owner	Oct 10	Yes
	Remove imported "Verified Buyer" reviews from display, fake review count, homepage proof wall	Claude/Owner (Judge.me)	Oct 11	Yes (legal)
	Clear never-charged compare-at prices; remove clearance from made-to-order; kill the countdown; fix the hero	Claude	Oct 11	Yes (legal)
	Rename Best Sellers → Editor's Picks; remove workshop/handmade claims; one warranty; one shipping truth	Claude	Oct 11	Yes
	Email suppliers for UL/ETL file numbers on every hardwired keep-list SKU	Owner	Oct 11 (answers by Oct 18)	Yes
	Book a trademark clearance consult on NORA (brand.md §1)	Owner	Oct 16	No (but before ad spend)
Oct 12-18	Unpublish everything off the keep list; delete stacked discount codes and the membership from nav	Claude	Oct 14	Yes
	Navigation to 6 items; homepage to 8 sections; trust strip under hero; fonts to Fraunces + Inter; card radius; secondary "lit" image	Claude (theme)	Oct 16	No

Week	Task	Owner	Deadline	Critical path?
	Google Voice number; founder note and photo; address and entity in footer	Owner	Oct 16	Yes
	Free-returns policy + prepaid label flow (Shopify returns); 1-year warranty text	Owner + Claude	Oct 16	Yes
	Delivery-date app/snippet replacing "In stock"	Claude	Oct 18	Yes
	Order samples of the 10 test SKUs (arrive ~14-21 days)	Owner	Oct 12	Yes (samples gate own photography; test can start with supplier photos if honest)
Oct 19-25	Spec tables on the 10 test SKUs; rewrite their copy; reprice per pricing.md	Claude + Owner (supplier data)	Oct 21	Yes
	Merchant Center feed re-sync; fix warnings; Judge.me review requests on	Owner	Oct 22	Yes
	Exclude internal traffic; bot filter	Owner	Oct 22	No
	Build the Shopping campaign (10 SKUs, \$25/day), not live	Owner	Oct 23	Yes
	Soft open: 3 friends/family place real orders at full price and report the experience end to end (refund them after if needed)	Owner	Oct 23-25	No
Oct 26	Relaunch	All	Oct 26	-

3. Relaunch day run sheet (Mon Oct 26, CT)

Time	What	Owner
8:00	Check site on phone: homepage, 3 product pages, cart, checkout (Apple Pay, card), chat, phone	Joe
8:30	Shopping campaign live; confirm products approved in Merchant Center	Joe
9:00	Email the 28 existing customers: founder note + relaunch offer (ends Nov 8)	Joe
9:30	10 trade outreach emails	Joe
10:00	Pinterest: 5 pins	Joe
12:00	Check ads: spend, clicks, disapprovals	Joe
13:00-17:00	Staff chat and phone; reply to every message within 1 hour	Joe
17:00	Log the day: sessions (real), add-to-carts, orders, questions asked (they are the next FAQ)	Joe
If something breaks	Checkout error → pause ads first, then debug. Merchant Center disapproval → fix the flagged field, don't appeal blind. Supplier out of stock → unpublish the SKU, email any buyer the same day with options.	Joe

4. The first 30 days

Weekly numbers (Mondays): real sessions; mobile add-to-cart ($\geq 3\%$); conversion ($\geq 0.7\%$ by day 30); CAC ($\leq \$117$); orders per day vs CFO break-even ($0.42/\text{day} \approx 13$ orders/month); refund rate ($< 10\%$); verified reviews collected (target 10 by day 45).

Reviews: - **Day 7 (Nov 2):** any orders yet? If clicks ≥ 150 and add-to-carts < 3 , the product page or price is the problem: change the price on the worst SKU and rewrite its top section. - **Day 14 (Nov 9):** test verdict against the success line. Pass $\rightarrow$ raise to \$40/day and add 10 SKUs. Fail $\rightarrow$ stop ads, keep organic and trade, revisit pricing and offer. - **Day 30 (Nov 25):** first deliveries reviewed. Refund reasons per SKU, delivery accuracy vs promised window, reviews in. Decide whether to stock the top 3 SKUs in the US (ops.md phase 2) before spring.

Holiday cutoff: "Order by Nov 24 for delivery before Dec 20" (overseas transit 14-21 days observed + 5-day buffer). Re-check against ops.md transit data before publishing.

Nora Furnish

- What it is: a US online store (Shopify, norafurnish.com) selling modern and statement lighting plus home decor, positioned as high-ticket ("modern lighting and home decor with free US shipping and 30 day returns").
- Who it is for: US homeowners furnishing or renovating (pendants, chandeliers, sconces, outdoor lanterns), plus a stated trade channel: designers, contractors, hospitality, short-term-rental owners, offices and retail (pages for each exist). Target customer not yet validated with data.
- What it sells, at what price: 1,819 active products (about 1,187 lighting, the rest decor, soft furnishings, seasonal). Prices: 595 under \$100, 854 at \$100-300, 596 at \$300-600, 398 at \$600-1,000, 391 at \$1,000+. Typical lighting item \$200-\$600. Unit costs recorded in Shopify run roughly 5x-17x below retail (e.g. a ceiling light costing \$8.66 sells at \$123.99).
- Where and how: online only, US only, free standard shipping, no minimum. "In stock" items arrive in 10-12 business days; made-to-order 3-4 weeks production + 9-10 business days transit. Fulfilled through suppliers (no inventory held: every active product shows 0 units with "continue selling"). 30-day returns, buyer pays return shipping on change-of-mind. Discounts: 10% first order, 10% on 2 items, 15% on 3+, paid membership with 20% off.
- Budget and constraints: solo founder (Edmond, Oklahoma), Shopify Basic plan. Marketing budget, cash available and time per week are NOT known yet (open question for /founder-cfo). Store has been live roughly since February 2026.

Traction so far (from Shopify, as of 2026-10-08)

- About 14,000 sessions since February 2026; 14 real customer orders (the rest were \$0 test orders), 4 of them refunded.
- Kept net revenue about \$2,601 (Aug-Oct 2026). AOV rising: \$56 in August, \$533 in September, \$995 in October.
- Real conversion about 0.1% of sessions. Google organic is the only channel that converts (1,889 sessions, 7 orders). A Sept 11-15 traffic spike (about 4,000 sessions, about 313 checkout reaches, 0 orders) and Facebook/Sweden/Ireland traffic look like bots.
- 28 customer records. 31 blog articles. 185 collections. Trade/custom service pages exist but no evidence of trade revenue yet.

Nora Furnish: store snapshot (Shopify Admin data, pulled 2026-10-08)

Sales

Month	Orders	Gross	Net sales	Note
Apr-May 2026	15	\$6,239	\$0	all \$0 owner test orders (100% discounted)
Jun 2026	1	\$109	\$0	refunded
Aug 2026	9	\$554	\$336	small items \$18-\$94, 2 refunds
Sep 2026	4	\$2,194	\$1,270	one \$862 order refunded, re-bought by same customer at \$819
Oct 2026 (to 8th)	1	\$1,170	\$995	Cloud Pendant x4, partially fulfilled

Real orders: 14. Refunded: 4 (29% by count). Kept net revenue: \$2,600.83. Products that sold: Motion Sensor LED Stair Light (\$862), Cloud Pendant Light (\$1,170 for 4), Adjustable Vanity Picture Light (\$285), Full Moon Wall Lamp (\$185), Outdoor LED Rope Tube String Lights (3 orders, \$143), plus sub-\$100 items.

Traffic and funnel (sessions)

- Monthly sessions: Feb 177, Mar 694, Apr 2,238, May 866, Jun 420, Jul 166, Aug 2,696, Sep 6,365, Oct (8 days) 436.
- Last 90 days by source: direct 6,755 (6 orders); Google organic 1,889 (7 orders); Facebook 591 (187 add-to-cart, 187 checkout, 0 orders); syndicated search 202; YouTube 35; ChatGPT 33; Google paid 21; Bing 12; Instagram 6; email 3.
- Sept 11-15 spike: about 4,050 sessions, 313 sessions "reached checkout", 0 orders. Only 4 abandoned checkouts with contact details exist in total, so these checkout reaches were almost certainly bots, not shoppers.
- Countries (90d): US 8,988 sessions (14 orders); Sweden 128 and Ireland 125 with 59 and 49 checkout reaches and 0 orders (bot signature; store ships US only).
- Device (90d): desktop 5,807 sessions, 392 checkout reaches, 5 orders; mobile 3,691 sessions, 20 checkout reaches, 8 orders.
- Top landing pages (60d): homepage 3,275 (0 orders); /collections/chandeliers 295; /password 275; cheap items lead organic entries (rope lights 243, shower curtain 223, Nordic wood ceiling light 181, solar flood light 155).
- Real purchase conversion: about 0.1% overall; Google organic about 0.37%.

Catalog

- 1,819 active, 248 draft, 185 collections, about 100 product types (with duplicates such as "Pendants"/"Pendant Lighting", "Vanity Lights"/"Vanity Lighting", "Step & Deck"/"Step and Deck").
- Lighting about 1,187 active; also decor, Halloween inflatables, fall decor, shower curtains, curtains, cushions, home fragrance, a "Membership" product.
- Price bands (active): <\$100: 595 | \$100-300: 854 | \$300-600: 596 | \$600-1,000: 398 | \$1,000+: 391. 165 flagged as price-reduced.

- Inventory: all active products 0 units with "continue selling" = supplier fulfilled (dropship).
- Sample unit costs vs price: Modern LED Aisle Surface Ceiling Light cost \$8.19-\$14.17, price \$123.99-\$167.99 (about 12-15x), compare-at \$146.99-\$197.99. Nordic Wood Round Hallway Ceiling Light cost \$9.43-\$11.79, price \$177.99-\$201.99 (about 17x). Long Linear Aluminum LED Ceiling Light cost \$30-\$51, price \$190-\$307 (about 6x). Ultrathin Wood Grain LED Ceiling Light cost \$43-\$70, price \$217-\$352 (about 5x).

Offer and policies

- Free US shipping, no minimum. In stock: 10-12 business days. Made to order: 3-4 weeks + 9-10 business days.
- 30-day returns; buyer pays return shipping on change-of-mind; must be unused in original packaging.
- Discounts live: WELCOME10, COMEBACK10, Welcome Back 5%, Buy 2+ save 10%, Buy 3+ save 15%, Member 20% off (sale items included), MEMBERWELCOME 20%, "Kevin 15".
- Contact: info@norafurnish.com, Mon-Fri 9-5 CST, address in Edmond, OK. No phone listed in policies.
- Pages: About, Our Story, FAQ, 2026 Lighting Catalog, Ideas & Guides, Professionals plus 8 industry project pages, Custom Lighting Studio, custom neon, custom curtains, custom chandeliers, bulk orders, project portfolio. 31 blog posts.
- Shopify Basic plan; custom theme "nora-v5-mobile-menu". 28 customer records.

Offers lens

Score: 3/10 | Vote: PASS

What is strong

- **The margins leave room to build a strong offer.** The sampled unit costs are 5x to 17x below retail (a \$8.66 ceiling light sells for \$123.99). Shipping and fees will take some of that, but there is clearly room to pay for a real guarantee, faster shipping or bonuses. Most stores that compete on price have no such room.
- **The buyers have money.** People renovating, interior designers, short-term-rental owners and hospitality buyers spend \$200 to \$1,000+ on fixtures. Average order value rose from \$56 in August to \$995 in October, and the Cloud Pendant sold as a set of 4 for \$1,170. People do buy here at high prices.
- **One channel works.** Google organic converts at about 0.37% (7 orders from 1,889 sessions). Buyers who arrive searching for something specific do sometimes buy. That is a signal of intent, though not yet proof of an offer.
- **The trade pages point at the market where the pain is.** Designers, contractors and short-term-rental owners have real, costly problems: deadlines, sourcing many matching fixtures, specs, ordering in bulk. Homeowners mostly *want* a nicer room. Trade buyers *need* a project to finish on time.

What would kill it (the top 3, most dangerous first)

1. **Buyers have no reason to believe it will work, so likelihood is near zero.** This is an unknown brand selling \$300 to \$1,000+ fixtures it has never handled, from suppliers whose names and quality checks are unknown. There are no reviews or proof the buyer can see. The data matches: about 0.1% of sessions buy, and 4 of 14 real orders (29%) were refunded. In this lens, perceived likelihood is where most offers die, and this one is failing there now. More traffic would mostly bring more refunds.
2. **It is a commodity whose only lever is discounts.** There are 1,819 products across lighting, Halloween inflatables, shower curtains and fragrance, with about 100 messy product types. That reads as a general store, not a destination. The reasons it gives to buy are all price cuts: WELCOME10, COMEBACK10, 10% off 2 items, 15% off 3+, 20% for members, "Kevin 15", and 165 items marked price-reduced against compare-at prices. If the same products are sold elsewhere for less, the margin that is this store's best asset will be competed away. Whether the same products are sold elsewhere is an open question.
/founder-competitors answers it.
3. **Delivery time and buyer effort are the worst parts of the value equation.** In-stock items take 10 to 12 business days. Made-to-order items take 3 to 4 weeks of production plus 9 to 10 business days in transit. A renovator on a schedule pays for that wait. If the buyer changes their mind, they pay return shipping on a bulky, fragile fixture, and it must be unused and in its original packaging. So the store asks for more patience and more risk than a buyer expects at these prices, and offers no guarantee to make up for it. The returns terms protect the store, not the buyer.

Market check (four tests)

- **The pain is massive:** weak for homeowners (a nice-to-have); moderate to strong for trade buyers working to a deadline.
- **Buyers have money:** yes.

- **Buyers are easy to find and reach:** partly. Google organic works at small volume. Customer acquisition cost is unknown because no meaningful paid ads have run. **/founder-cfo** needs this number, and so does a small paid test.
- **The market is growing:** unknown. I will not guess. **/founder-competitors** can size it.

The questions I would ask the founder

1. Who is the one buyer? Pick one: homeowner, interior designer or short-term-rental owner. Each needs a different offer.
2. Why were the 4 orders refunded: quality, delivery time, or the product not matching its photos? Your refunds are the only real customer feedback you have.
3. What is the landed cost of one order, including the supplier's shipping, payment fees and the cost of a return? Without that, nobody knows if a guarantee is affordable. (**/founder-cfo**)
4. Can buyers find the same products elsewhere, and at what price? (**/founder-competitors**)
5. Would a target buyer pay full price with no discount code, and what would make them say yes? (**/founder-consumer**)
6. What can you guarantee and actually deliver: a delivery date, free returns, a quality check before shipping? Do your suppliers support it?
7. Could you double the price for one segment and still be the obvious choice? If not, what is missing?

If FUND IF: the conditions

Not a FUND IF. As it stands, this is a general catalogue store with slow shipping, no proof and only discounts to offer, and the traction so far (14 orders, 29% refunded) does not argue otherwise. I would vote again if the founder came back with: - **One segment and one category.** For example, lighting for short-term-rental owners or designers, with the catalogue cut to the products that serve them. - **An offer stack built around that buyer's problems.** For example: a guaranteed ship-by date, help choosing fixtures, matching sets, free returns on the first order and trade pricing. Each item costed by /founder-cfo so the guarantee is affordable. - **Proof.** Reviews, photos of installed fixtures, or named project work from the first trade customers. - **Fewer, honest discounts.** Drop the stacked codes and replace them with value the buyer can see. - **Evidence it converts.** A small test, run with /founder-consumer before launch and then with real traffic, showing buyers in that segment purchasing at full price with a refund rate well below today's.

Monopoly lens

Score: 2/10 | Vote: PASS

What is strong

- **The gross margin on paper is wide.** Recorded unit costs run 5x to 17x below retail. That gap is the only real asset here, but under this lens wide margins on generic goods are not a moat. They are a signal to copycats, and competition usually closes them.
- **There is one channel that works.** Google organic is the only source that converts (about 0.37%, 7 of 14 orders), and it rests on 31 blog posts and a large indexed catalogue. Content-led search is the only durable distribution asset in sight. It could compound.
- **Average order value is climbing** (\$56, then \$533, then \$995) and a \$1,170 four-pendant order shows that buyers of statement lighting exist. On 14 orders this is a hint, not a trend.
- **No inventory risk.** Dropshipping keeps the downside small while the founder looks for a niche.

What would kill it (the top 3, most dangerous first)

1. **There is no monopoly anywhere: the business is a commodity reseller in an open market.** The store sells 1,819 supplier-fulfilled SKUs across about 100 product types, from chandeliers to Halloween inflatables and shower curtains, all shipped by third parties. A ceiling light that costs \$8.66 and sells for \$123.99 is almost certainly a generic factory item that anyone with a Shopify account can list. Whether these exact products are sold elsewhere, and at what prices, is open; /founder-competitors answers it. If they are, buyers can find the same item cheaper with one image search. None of the four sources of durability applies. There is no proprietary product, no network effect, no scale advantage (Shopify Basic, 28 customers) and no brand yet. Nothing stops a copycat in month six, because the copycat may already exist.
2. **Distribution is not solved, and the competition for it is big and well funded.** About 14,000 sessions produced 14 real orders. Strip out bots and that is still roughly 0.1%. Paid acquisition has never been tested, so CAC is unknown (/founder-cfo, after a small paid test). Organic search for "pendant light" or "chandelier" is contested by large home-goods retailers and marketplaces with far more authority and faster delivery. A store with 10 to 26 business days of delivery and buyer-paid returns is competing on price and selection against the players who own price and selection.
3. **No secret, and no small market to own first.** The brief states no insight that others lack. The seven trade pages (designers, contractors, hospitality, short-term rentals, offices, retail) spread a solo founder across seven markets at once, with no trade revenue in any of them. A 29% refund rate by count (4 of 14) also hints at a quality or expectation gap with unknown suppliers. That is the opposite of building a brand.

The questions I would ask the founder

- Pick five bestsellers. Can a buyer find the identical product elsewhere, and at what price? (/founder-competitors)
- What do you know about lighting buyers that the big retailers do not? If the answer is nothing yet, which narrow segment could you learn it in?
- What is the one small market you could hold 30%+ of within 18 months? Candidates: short-term-rental lighting packages, a single style niche, or the Oklahoma City designer trade.

- How do the first 100 customers arrive, and what does each one cost? (/founder-cfo for CAC and payback, /founder-consumer for who actually buys)
- Why did 4 of 14 orders refund? What would a stricter supplier QC process cost?
- Why now? What has changed in lighting retail that opens a gap for a new store in 2026?
- What would make a Nora product impossible to buy anywhere else: exclusive designs, a custom or made-to-order line, or curated bundles with design service?

If FUND IF: the conditions

Not applicable: the vote is PASS. The founder can bring it back with three things: 1. **One niche, named and narrow**, with the catalogue cut to the few hundred SKUs that serve it. For example, statement pendants for short-term-rental owners, sold as room packages. 2. **A differentiator a copycat cannot list overnight**: exclusive or private-label designs, custom work (the Custom Lighting Studio page already exists), or a design service bundled with the product. 3. **Proof of repeatable distribution**: 30+ real, non-refunded orders from a known channel, with a CAC measured against margin after shipping, fees and returns (/founder-cfo).

Product lens

Score: 3/10 | Vote: PASS

The lens asks what the one thing is, and what the customer's first five minutes feel like. Right now Nora Furnish can't answer either. It is a catalog, not a product: 1,819 active items, 185 collections and about 100 product types, several of them duplicated ("Pendants"/"Pendant Lighting"). It sells Halloween inflatables and shower curtains next to \$1,000+ chandeliers, offers custom neon, custom curtains and custom chandeliers, and has 8 industry pages for a trade channel with no trade revenue. The pitch, "modern lighting and home decor with free US shipping and 30 day returns", describes a policy, not a product. Any dropship store could say the same sentence.

What is strong

- **A real signal is buried in the data.** Google organic converts at about 0.37%, against about 0.1% overall, and the orders getting bigger are lighting: Cloud Pendant x4 at \$1,170, Motion Sensor Stair Light at \$862, Vanity Picture Light at \$285. Someone searching for a specific light, landing on it and buying is the only experience that works today.
- **The margin pays for craft.** Recorded unit costs are 5x to 17x below retail. Few businesses can afford to inspect every unit, ship faster and take returns for free. This one could, if it chose to.
- **Lighting suits this lens.** A statement pendant is seen every day and judged on detail. If the product and the delivery were excellent, customers would show it off to guests.
- **There is groundwork to build on:** 31 blog posts, a custom theme, and a store that has been live for eight months.

What would kill it (the top 3, most dangerous first)

1. **The price promises more than the product delivers.** The positioning is "high-ticket statement lighting". The sampled products cost \$8 to \$14 and sell for \$124 to \$202. When a customer pays \$124 and opens a box holding an \$8 light, sent from an unnamed supplier with no visible QC, the brand loses them. Craft in the parts nobody sees is exactly what dropshipping can't promise. Four of 14 real orders were refunded (29%). That sample is too small to prove anything, but it is the first number to watch, and the brief records no refund reasons.
2. **The business owns almost none of the experience.** After checkout, every touchpoint belongs to someone else. "In stock" items carry zero inventory and take 10-12 business days. Made-to-order takes 3-4 weeks plus 9-10 days in transit. Packaging, condition on arrival and tracking all sit with the supplier, and a buyer who changes their mind about a chandelier pays to ship it back. The weak points are the handoffs: store to supplier, supplier to carrier, customer back to store. Nothing in the brief shows anyone owns them.
3. **There is no focus, so there is no product.** The 1,819 SKUs, the 8 live discount mechanisms (WELCOME10, COMEBACK10, a 20% membership that also applies to sale items, "Kevin 15" and others) and the six service lines all pull attention away from the one experience that converts. The homepage drew 3,275 sessions and 0 orders, and visitors who do arrive from search mostly land on cheap items (rope lights, a shower curtain, solar flood lights). A store that tries to be everything shows visitors no reason to trust it with a \$600 light. Constant discounting also tells them the list price isn't real.

The questions I would ask the founder

- Say what Nora Furnish is in one sentence, without mentioning shipping, returns or discounts.
- Have you held each of your top 20 lights in your own hands? What did the box, the finish and the instructions feel like?
- Why was each of the 4 orders refunded? Did the \$862 stair-light customer return it and then buy it again at \$819 because of the product or because of the price?
- If you could keep only 50 products, which would they be, and why those?
- Can you name the supplier behind every live product? What happens today when one arrives broken?
- Open questions I can't answer from the brief:
- Are these same items sold elsewhere for much less, so that a customer could find the \$8 light at \$20?

/founder-competitors

- Will the target buyer wait 2-5 weeks for a \$300-\$1,000 light from a brand they don't know? **/founder-consumer**
- What does one order really cost once supplier shipping, refunds, discounts and processing fees are counted? **/founder-cfo**

If FUND IF: the conditions

Not applicable, because the vote is PASS. The current business is a generic dropship catalog with no owned experience, and making the store "perfect in every way" would only polish that catalog. These are the steps that would bring it back to this board: 1. Cut to one category the founder can stand behind. The sales data points to statement pendants and wall lights. Aim for about 50-100 SKUs, each sampled in hand. 2. Choose products whose quality matches the price, or lower the price to match the quality. Drop any item the founder wouldn't hang in their own home. 3. Take back the handoffs: an inspected or stocked set of best-sellers, honest delivery dates instead of "in stock" labels that hide a two-week wait, branded packaging, and free returns on lighting. 4. Replace the discount stack with one clear price. 5. Show a refund rate under about 10% across at least 30 real orders in the focused category.

None of these steps needs to be clever, but each one is a decision to say no.

```

{
  "business": "Nora Furnish (online lighting store, supplier-fulfilled from China)",
  "unit": "order",
  "price": 350.0,
  "variable": [
    {
      "label": "Product cost from supplier (est. 25% of order value; recorded costs run 7-44% of current prices, 14% on the $279 hero pendant)",
      "cost": 87.5
    },
    {
      "label": "Supplier shipping China to US per order (est.; confirm whether Shopify unit cost includes it)",
      "cost": 30.0
    },
    {
      "label": "Shopify Payments 2.9% + $0.30",
      "cost": 10.45
    },
    {
      "label": "Refunds allowance (est. 10% of orders refunded and written off; today 4 of 14)",
      "cost": 35.0
    },
    {
      "label": "Discounts (bundle 10% on extra pieces + one welcome offer; est. 5% of order value)",
      "cost": 17.5
    },
    {
      "label": "Guarantee stack: free return labels, late-delivery credit, 1-year warranty, damage replacements (offer.md)",
      "cost": 20.3
    },
    {
      "label": "Blended customer acquisition cost per order (est. $120; paid ads untested)",
      "cost": 120.0
    }
  ],
  "fixed_monthly": [
    {
      "label": "Shopify Basic plan",
      "cost": 39
    },
    {
      "label": "Apps: Judge.me reviews, delivery-date, email (est.)",
      "cost": 100
    },
    {
      "label": "Google Workspace, domain, Google Voice (est.)",
      "cost": 25
    },
    {
      "label": "Ongoing QC samples and photography (est.)",
      "cost": 200
    }
  ],
  "startup": [
    {

```

```
    "label": "Sample and inspect 30 hero SKUs (est. $80 each incl. shipping)",
    "cost": 2400
  },
  {
    "label": "Own product and lifestyle photography of samples (est.)",
    "cost": 600
  },
  {
    "label": "Trademark clearance opinion on the NORA conflict + USPTO filing for the final name (est.)",
    "cost": 850
  },
  {
    "label": "Review requests, returns portal and delivery-date app setup (est.)",
    "cost": 150
  },
  {
    "label": "Relaunch test ad spend, first 30 days (est.)",
    "cost": 1000
  }
],
"days_per_month": 30,
"capacity_per_day": 20,
"plan_per_day": 1.0,
"ramp_per_day": [
  0.05,
  0.1,
  0.15,
  0.25,
  0.35,
  0.45,
  0.55,
  0.65,
  0.75,
  0.85,
  0.9,
  1.0
]
}
```